STORYTABLE

User Manual

Edition 0.1.502

Plan from evidence. Build with intention. Review before you publish.

Windows and macOS Workspace

www.storytable.app/manual

The manual edition matches the application release.

> *StoryTable Workspace UI*

> *Edition 0.1.502 - Windows and macOS*

Reusing a weekly project (0.1.502)

Open Project Actions at the top of a project to rename it, save a separate copy, or save its setup as a Preset. The same actions are in the File menu. Rename changes the displayed project name without moving its folder.

Save As asks for the new project name and destination together. It copies sources, pages and artwork and opens the independent copy. The project-card Save As action waits for the selected project to finish opening before displaying this form.

For a new weekly issue, choose Save as Preset. Review the recurring editorial instructions and, for Something Else, the reusable goal description. Remove last week's names, selected story and other issue-specific directions. The preset keeps the selected Goal, Deliverable, Channel, audience, styles, Brand and layout defaults. It does not copy source files, pages, generated artwork or revision history. Choose New Project · Preset, name the new issue, and add the new newsletter and photos. Instructions remain editable.

Project Files · Remove File removes a source document and its source record, or an unused source photo. Original files outside the project remain intact. Photos used by output pages must first be detached from those pages. Export and log files go to the Recycle Bin; project metadata and generated artwork are managed through their respective editors.

Audio for marker artwork (0.1.501 / Bridge 0.3.69)

Marker artwork reads existing transcripts only. Audio without a transcript, including background music and clips whose source Premiere cannot expose, is excluded without blocking the artwork or requesting transcription. Nested narration with a transcript remains available. Choose a narration track to exclude other tracks.

Audio to use also offers No audio - marker notes and images only. Ignore audio clips accepts one exact clip name per line; these clips stay excluded even if they later have transcripts. Both choices are saved with the project. Changing them clears the old quote and requires a fresh review. These settings affect StoryTable's inputs, not playback or the Premiere timeline.

Image preparation (0.1.500)

Image requests use the selected references' saved directions and omit instructions explicitly assigned to unused style-reference images. Your saved Library style and original files stay intact; selecting a different reference brings its instructions back. Requests that fit the image service limit go straight to image generation. Larger requests still use the existing verified preparation process. Image rendering time depends on the image service.

File selection in Premiere (0.1.499 / Bridge 0.3.67)

On Windows, the StoryTable file browser stays above the editing windows. While it is open, the fixed panel footer shows Waiting for file selection, Show file browser and Cancel selection. Cancel closes that selection and returns to your current artwork brief with existing photos unchanged. Stop task remains for actual engine work. Initial connection pairing and older engines use the native browser: choose files or Cancel in that window; use Alt+Tab if it is hidden.

Revise / Edit Image is directly below completed marker and History images and in the enlarged generated-image preview. Show in Folder reveals the saved file. Switch Project is visible in the header; matching project names include

their folders so separate projects are distinguishable.

Saved artwork files (0.1.498 / Bridge 0.3.63)

Show in Folder selects the saved image in Windows Explorer (or reveals it in Finder on Mac). The command remains available during image generation. If the file is missing or the system cannot show it, the panel displays the reason. Open Image continues to use your default image viewer.

New completed artwork has one final PNG. Source snapshots are kept in a separate sources subfolder and reused when the same unchanged image is used again. Temporary recovery images remain in the work subfolder only while generation/composition is incomplete. Existing files are preserved so Premiere media links and old revisions keep working; the update does not clean up older duplicates automatically.

Library startup in Premiere (0.1.497 / Bridge 0.3.61)

Visual Style, Brand and Character choices begin loading when the StoryTable engine starts. Opening the Bridge retrieves these choices independently of ongoing generation and saved-artwork thumbnails. Your saved Visual Style stays selected. Review becomes available when the Library choices have loaded; if loading fails, Retry Visual Styles appears beside the style selector and the saved choice is retained.

Artwork thumbnails load separately. A pending generation continues to report its own progress while Library choices load. Reading the Library does not submit another generation or replace that job.

Confirming artwork placement (0.1.496 / Bridge 0.3.59)

Placement reports progress and its result beside the main action button. A confirmed placement identifies the destination track and time range. If the same image already occupies that exact range on that track, the panel confirms it without inserting another copy. Other occupied ranges remain protected; choose an empty destination video track.

After Premiere accepts an edit, the panel checks the inserted image and duration. Temporary missing source handles are reread without repeating the insertion. If confirmation is still unavailable, the message says the edit was accepted and directs you to inspect the named track and range before retrying. Saved images remain available through Open Image and Show in Folder.

Premiere task, source and gallery controls (0.1.495 / Bridge 0.3.58)

Use What would you like to do? in the header to choose a task. It stays available in Settings, History and Library, and includes B-roll at markers. The duplicate Analysis task menu is removed from the visible interface. Legacy writing navigation appears only when explicitly expanded.

The selected Visual Style stays selected across marker navigation, refresh and reopening. During Library loading the selector says it is loading. An unavailable saved style remains identified as unavailable; generation stops until you restore it or explicitly choose another style or No visual style. A delayed Library response from a previous project cannot change the current selection.

Revisions retain their own original rendering and subject photos by default. Remove Image and Clear Source Images explicitly exclude photos from the next request. Undo Clear Source Images restores a clear operation. Photos intentionally removed are not silently inherited again. The ambiguous cross-marker Reuse previous sources shortcut is removed. Saved revision drafts show the original artwork's photos together with any deliberate additions, so you can review the actual input list.

In B-roll mode History opens Generated artwork directly: one scrollable gallery containing generated image files. Completed batch wrappers, interrupted requests and requests without images are kept in a separate collapsed Requests & Batches section. There is no Older artwork paging. Image cards show the scene name and timing when available; double-click enlargement, file actions and Edit / Place Image remain available.

Large source photographs (0.1.494)

High-resolution JPEG source photos, including 36-megapixel camera originals, are reduced by the JPEG decoder into bounded upload references. The full-resolution files on disk stay unchanged. EXIF rotation is applied to the upload copy; source count, aspect ratio and the existing per-image and combined upload budgets are retained. A photo that cannot be read or reduced safely produces an actionable error in the Premiere panel.

Revising marker artwork (0.1.493 / Bridge 0.3.55)

Choose Revise This Artwork to edit an existing image. Enter only the changes you want. The selected original rendering, its original scene brief and its content source photos are retained through successive revisions. Style Only reference images continue to supply design descriptions without becoming content attachments.

Choose New Artwork from This Marker in the marker header to leave revision mode. This restores that marker's extra directions and uploads and enables Use images on the timeline. Review Markers & Cost reads the marker's current timeline images again and shows the planned scenes and sources before you approve generation. Earlier images remain in History. Previous/Next marker keep each marker's extra directions and uploads separate.

The header states whether you are editing an existing image or creating new artwork. For marker artwork, the History inspector's main placement action uses the saved matching dialogue timing.

Resizing the page workspace (0.1.492)

In Create & Refine, drag the visible dividers to resize the page list, artwork preview and page editor. On narrower windows these panels stack vertically; the page list keeps enough height to remain readable. Returning to a previous window layout restores the panel sizes you chose during that session.

If a panel has become awkwardly sized, double-click a divider or choose Reset Panel Sizes above the workspace. This restores the default panel sizes and keeps your page text, source assignments and artwork unchanged.

Text-free B-roll and Style Only examples (0.1.491 / panel 0.3.47)

Marker B-roll creates illustrations for separate kinetic typography. It does not add headlines, body text, paraphrased transcript copy, labels or handwritten notes. The original transcript remains evidence and scene context, not display wording. Saved style typography rules are inactive for this workflow.

Style Only examples contribute their saved design descriptions. Their image pixels are withheld from the image generator, so sample people, yearbook photos, childhood pictures and example captions cannot be supplied as scene images. Creative Inspiration examples with explicit treatment-only restrictions receive the same protection. The selected style's palette, materials, collage treatment and descriptive directions remain available. Add or analyze a design description if a style contains only example images without descriptive guidance.

Timeline content photos remain image inputs. Marker B-roll revisions start from approved original sources rather than reusing a previous composite that may contain borrowed material or unwanted text. Earlier completed artwork and all Library files remain preserved. Pending requests prepared before this update must use Edit & Reprice Request before

generation. To replace an earlier result, make a new reviewed request or revise that artwork; installation does not replace existing image files.

B-roll at Premiere markers (0.1.490 / panel 0.3.46)

Open the sequence in Premiere and choose B-roll at markers in the Bridge header. If no StoryTable project is open, the shortcut creates a B-roll project for that sequence. Choose a B-roll Visual Style and Markers to illustrate, then Review Markers & Cost. Check the scenes and price before choosing Approve & Generate. Completed images retain their marker timing; use Place at Matching Dialogue on a finished image to place it on an empty destination video track. Placement remains a separate action.

Choose all sequence markers, one marker, selected markers checked in the panel, or markers starting within the sequence In/Out range. Use Refresh Marker List to choose one marker or check several. These are panel selections; Premiere's marker highlight selection is not read by this workflow. A point marker runs to the next sequence marker or sequence end. A duration marker keeps its duration; In/Out selection clips coverage at the Out point. Overlapping selected marker ranges must be adjusted or selected separately.

Each scene receives its intended duration, local timed transcript, and the overall sequence transcript as context for resolving references and narrative meaning. Marker names/comments remain visual direction rather than spoken evidence. One illustration is planned per marker. Original PNG, JPEG and WebP stills overlapping each range are attached automatically from enabled video tracks; muted tracks, disabled clips, video clips and nested video sequences are excluded. An optional track number limits the image or narration source. Missing dialogue can be supplemented by marker direction or images; it is never invented as a quotation. Review reports unavailable transcripts.

Timeline, transcript and marker changes require another review before paid generation. Existing artwork, Libraries and source files are retained.

Automatic photo pages use the actual visual style (0.1.487)

Assigned Visual Style examples are attached as visual design references, including for Use image as-is in styled layout. Their layout, framing, materials and visual rhythm guide the page; their people, photographs and words are not additional page content. Every original photo remains required once.

For still photo pages with Automatic placement, the image generator composes the actual photos and approved wording together using the active style. It does not force a rotating left/right text third. With Text in Art off, it designs an image-only page without an empty headline panel or reserved text column. Explicit text positions, reported subject positions, selected Layouts and timed video/Premiere compositions retain their existing controls. Original photo files and saved style definitions remain unchanged.

Give the assignment once, then choose a story

In Editorial Desk, add your sources and describe the complete intended result in Coverage Brief. Include required sections, page allocations, optional content, exclusions and what you want to choose from the suggested stories. Select Output format separately. It stays selected when you edit the brief.

Choose Find Story Opportunities, then Build project with this story on the option you want. The build uses the full original brief and all included sources in the same project. A selected feature does not replace the rest of a newsletter assignment. You do not re-enter the instructions or create another project. If you have not selected the output format, the story-selection screen asks for that choice before building.

Next: Choose Story Direction opens the larger story-review screen, which has the same format choice and Build project with this story action. Existing combined choices remain under Review story choices... and Build saved story

choices. The original pitches and sources remain available.

For visual outputs, the image estimate opens after the pages are written. Approve it to create artwork, or cancel to review and edit the pages first. Revise Plan... changes those pages; Build Project... creates their artwork. Back to story choices returns to the original ideas. Existing separate commissioned projects remain accessible through Open Story Project.

For example, a weekly issue can request seven section pages, a 6-8-page feature, one Photo of the Week page, optional announcements and a 20-page maximum. Keep that complete assignment in the original brief; selecting a feature supplies the remaining editorial choice. These are authoring instructions, not a dedicated section-count validator. Review the resulting pages before approving artwork.

Choose a Premiere sequence for publishing (0.1.481 / panel 0.3.44)

In Video Publishing, Use selected Premiere sequence reads the sequence selected in Premiere's Project panel. Use active sequence reads the open timeline. The source name confirms the chosen edit. Each also has an explicitly named option to use a brief without a transcript.

A failed selection is shown as incomplete and must be retried before creating a publishing package or sending its copy to Premiere. The previous saved package remains intact. Graphics without a Project-bin item are supported, and their identity and timing remain part of the edit-change check.

Interview to post ideas to Premiere timelines (0.1.481 / panel 0.3.44)

Select an interview clip in Premiere's Project panel, then click Post ideas from selected clips in the Bridge header. Add an optional focus, such as thought leadership for parents, and click Find Instagram post ideas. This prepares the selected transcripts and uses them for the request. When no StoryTable project is open, the shortcut creates a project for the selected interview. To start a separate project while another is open, choose New Project, enter its name, and click Start a post-ideas project. Goal and Preset selection is optional for this path. Existing project plans are preserved.

Each result card shows the idea once. Click Create timeline for this idea to build its recorded passages in Premiere. To build several, select their idea checkboxes and click Create timelines for selected ideas. Each selected idea always becomes a separate named timeline. Use Review interview passages to inspect the original speech and source times or omit individual passages. Hooks and captions remain writing notes; they are not fabricated spoken lines. A completed idea is removed from the batch selection so retrying an interrupted batch continues with the remaining ideas. Existing saved Instagram idea results use these controls without another AI request.

The task selector stays visible on Plan screens. Content Opportunity Finder now uses Find Content Opportunities for its action; it remains a broader written opportunity report, separate from the direct post-idea and timeline workflow.

Download the questionnaire for your own AI (0.1.477)

Click Download AI Questionnaire on the Library screen, in Library Context, or at the top of Storyteller Profiler. One click saves the blank Markdown questionnaire to your Downloads folder and shows an Open folder link. It includes the questions and instructions for your AI to return an importable profile. No completed answers, Library context, or uploaded documents are included, and downloading does not use AI credits or require an AI account. An existing edited file is preserved; StoryTable uses a numbered filename when needed.

Give the file to your own AI. Bring its returned JSON or Markdown profile back through Storyteller Profiler · Review and

exchange · Import returned profile, review it, and save Library Context.

Reopening projects with missing artwork (0.1.476)

If a saved artwork revision is missing but its exact exported page copy remains inside the project, StoryTable restores that revision after checking its file hash. The selected version, page plan, source photos and artwork history remain the same. A different image is never substituted automatically.

If artwork still needs recovery, the project opens in Create & Refine, where you can review the affected page and regenerate its artwork. Missing source references lead to Plan. Project Files remains available from the sidebar; its visible image thumbnails load in the background so navigation stays usable. Successful regeneration clears that page's old missing-artwork warning while preserving any unresolved warnings for other pages.

Integrate original photographs in the selected style (0.1.486)

Use image as-is in styled layout sends the assigned original photographs and applicable visual references to the image provider together with the active Visual Style. The provider creates the complete page, including framing, background, typography and the placement of every assigned photograph. The request requires each photo once with its people, visible content and readable marks retained. StoryTable saves this finished design without pasting photos into a generated backing afterward. Original source files stay unchanged. Review the generated artwork for photo fidelity; this does not guarantee exact pixel reproduction by the provider.

Earlier locally composed images remain in history and are marked for rebuilding. Regenerate the page to use the integrated design path. Text-only and selected-area edits no longer paste old photo rectangles over the provider's edit. Selected-area edits still preserve pixels outside the chosen edit rectangle.

Plain photos on white - no AI remains an explicit separate choice.

Create a single collage from photo pages (0.1.474)

To rebuild an existing version, select that output, set Target Pages/cards to 1 and photo density to No limit, then choose Rebuild This Output from Source Images in the page plan. Review and approve the one-page proposal. This replaces the selected output's plan; the other outputs keep their own plans. Single Graphic also makes Auto choose one page. Simple photo planning uses source order, page count and the deliverable; use AI-curated story and captions when the brief should guide semantic grouping and writing.

In Create Another Version, choose Single Graphic. Compatible photo pages combine into one page with all their assigned photos and existing text. The dialog shows the photo count before creation. The new version keeps its own Visual Style, page plan and artwork; the original carousel stays available in the output selector. Combining the page plan does not require AI analysis or generate artwork. Review the combined copy before creating the image.

If a plan contains page-specific content that cannot be combined directly, the dialog explains that the new format needs a fresh plan from the shared source files. Uncheck the inheritance option to start without a page plan.

Photo pages and Visual Style (0.1.473)

Styled photo pages - selected Visual Style is the default photo planning choice for Photo Slide Show projects. It arranges supplied images without requiring a brief, photo analysis or captions. Creating styled artwork uses the selected Visual Style and the normal AI generation quote. Plain photos on white - no AI remains an explicit alternative. AI-curated story and captions adds reviewed photo interpretation and editorial selection.

To change an existing plan's appearance, open Plan · Visual Style · Current photo pages, or Create & Refine · Art Direction · Photo pages in this output. Choose Use selected Visual Style or Plain photos on white - no AI. Page order,

assignments, authored text and accepted image history stay saved. Use Create or Apply and Regenerate to make new artwork. Re-analyzing photos or rebuilding the page plan is not required to change appearance.

Original-photo slideshows (0.1.472)

In Plan · Sources · Images · Build a Page Plan from Photos, choose Plain photos on white - no AI for local white-background layouts. This is an explicit option. Select all photos or a selection, choose Auto or an exact page count, and review the proposed photo assignments before applying the plan. All chosen photos are used once, in their current source order. Auto respects the output's page limit; for a carousel, excess photos share cards. The density control can limit photos per card, and incompatible counts show an explanation.

Use Create to fit the original photographs intact on plain white canvases, then Export to make the publication package. This route requires no AI analysis, generated artwork, sign-in, or credits. It does not apply generative Visual Style decoration. Exact Page Text can be added in Plan and rendered locally when text in artwork is enabled. Existing photos and revisions are kept.

Choose AI story and captions for evidence-based story selection and styled artwork. If photo analysis fails, the actual service error is shown before a story proposal is requested. Provider account failures stop the batch before remaining photos are submitted; unattempted photos keep their existing data.

Storyteller Profiler (0.1.471)

Open Library · Library Context · Storyteller Profiler. Panel Only users can open Storyteller Profile in the Premiere Engine window. Start with a few sentences, add readable documents, or use the optional Interview me tab. Click Start interview to get the first question; you can leave the answer box empty or type an optional introduction first. After a question appears, type your reply and click Send answer. Ask another question skips to a new question when the answer box is empty. Opening the tab alone does not request AI. Choose the file purpose before adding it: organization background, authentic writing, or examples of strong and weak stories. Text, Markdown, searchable PDF, Word, SRT, CSV and HTML are supported. Original files stay in place; complete readable text and interview answers are retained with the Library.

Create profile with AI proposes mission, values, audience distinctions, editorial priorities, sensitivities, story judgment and a learned writing voice. Large intake is processed in named parts without discarding the middle. Review the current/proposed fields, provenance and unanswered questions, then choose Review and use profile. You can edit every proposed field. Save profile inputs saves intake and an unfinished draft without replacing reviewed fields. Saving the enclosing Library Context commits the changes. Existing projects keep a snapshot unless you choose to apply the update to the open project's outputs.

To use your own AI, click Download AI Questionnaire. It includes a flexible blank questionnaire and the version 1 exchange format. For a custom save location or to optionally include your current reviewed profile, use Export AI Questionnaire in Review and exchange. Check Include my Library's currently saved profile in the exported questionnaire to add that Library's saved profile to the questions. Leave it unchecked for a blank questionnaire. Review and save an imported or generated draft before including it. Give the Markdown file to your AI and ask it for a downloadable JSON profile or Markdown containing one JSON block. Import returned profile validates and previews it without an AI call. Export reviewed profile shares approved fields and uncertainty notes; it excludes raw uploads and interview answers.

An optional learned-voice setting applies the identity to authored institutional writing in third person as well as first person, preserving the narrator and exact quoted speech. Story discovery and Premiere idea/search/edit paths now receive the saved Library context, selected Writing Voice and resolved AI Assistant lens. Changing the profile invalidates the corresponding discovery request caches. Profile examples guide relevance and language; they do not establish facts in a new story. The profiler does not certify human equivalence. Review fresh ideas and drafts to

establish whether its judgment and voice match your own.

Matching asset results (0.1.470)

Matching asset creation reports attempts separately from usable files. The live status shows how many assets were created and how many failed. An incomplete batch reports the requested, created, failed and unattempted counts when exported. If a generated component is unusable or the provider account needs repair, StoryTable stops further requests and retains returned images separately for review. Existing usable artwork remains available. Further generation requires a new cost review and approval.

Frames tolerate negligible alpha noise in empty photo openings, and text panels accept nearly opaque paper textures. These checks preserve the original pixels; hollow writing surfaces and visibly filled photo openings still fail validation.

Photo evidence for slide and image-led outlines (0.1.469)

Create Project Outline prepares missing source-photo analysis automatically for a slide or other image-led outline, then reuses saved reviewed findings. An initial outline can use its unassigned photo collection. Explicit story/page creative effects continue to control the selected photos, and page-specific edits keep their existing scope. Slide decks use the selected presentation goal and brief; they do not require Instagram setup or Instagram concept mapping.

Premiere Panel Only and Full Suite (Windows)

Network and removable-drive projects use a private local working copy while open. Automatic saves keep edits in that copy. Choose Save Project to update the original project location; closing also saves there. The verified local copy is retained for the next opening. Reopening checks the saved project and reuses unchanged cached files; it copies only new, changed or damaged files. Image revision history remains available. Opening and saving still depend on network speed, while ordinary page editing and image moves run locally. Projects on fixed local disks already work locally and need no extra copy.

If the drive disconnects, a save fails, or StoryTable crashes, the working copy is kept for recovery. Reopen the same project to recover it. If the original project was changed elsewhere, use Save As to preserve your edited version in another folder. Saved locally means the original location has not yet been updated. A successful Save reports Saved to the project location.

Character Preview and Model Sheet requests share each reference behavior definition while retaining every source's assignment and saved directions. Past preview and model-sheet filenames stay in the saved Character record; generation uses the current identity guidance and attachment manifest.

In the desktop Library or a project's Characters section, Create Model Sheet also works for Characters saved as Use supplied references as-is or Design later. Choose a Visual Style for that sheet, then confirm generation. The sheet uses the Character's identity references and preserves its saved style setting, uploaded images, previews and earlier sheets. Canceling the style dialog submits no AI request. If a Character has an assigned style, that style is used.

Export Library preserves current categories, removed-item state, attributes and tags. Maintenance backup definitions stay on disk and are excluded from the reusable Library and style selectors.

In Create Artwork, use Remove Artwork on an image or Remove Image Set on a set to clear it from the panel. Undo Remove reverses the last removal; Show Removed Artwork lets you restore earlier removals after reopening the panel. Removing artwork preserves the image files used by Premiere sequences. Use Remove Request to clear an unwanted saved generation request.

When selecting a file or folder, the panel displays Waiting for file selection. Choose an item or cancel the native selection window to return to the panel.

Install StoryTable Premiere Panel Only and the bundled StoryTable Bridge CCX. Start StoryTable Premiere Engine from the Start menu, then connect the panel to Documents/StoryTable/premiere/connection.json. The desktop app is not required. The engine window lets you select any of your Libraries. Refresh the panel after switching Libraries. Use Open Project from Disk for an existing .story file.

The Full Suite and Panel Only engine use the same Documents/StoryTable data, settings, project history, Libraries, attachments, and operating-system credential storage. Upgrading requires no data export or conversion. Uninstalling the program leaves user data intact. The Full Suite installer updates both Desktop and Premiere Engine in one operation, with separate shortcuts; one owns the shared workspace at a time. The Panel Only installer uses the same install identity, so installing the Full Suite upgrades it in place. Panel Only updates refuse to update an existing Full Suite to avoid leaving its desktop behind. Switch to Full Suite transfers an idle engine's open project to the installed desktop. To return to Panel Only, close the desktop and start StoryTable Premiere Engine. Active work blocks engine closure and switching. Pairing is retained across switches.

Under the panel's Settings, Video Goal and Video Preset include YouTube Packaging, interview edits, Reel and lyric-video storyboards, Slide Show, Digital Signage, presentation/screen presets, Product Campaign, and video research goals. Video Deliverable preserves the chosen output. Add transcripts in Sources, add frames or photos, save the brief, and build the video plan. For a finished Premiere sequence, open Export > Video Publishing to create publishing copy and thumbnail options in the existing project. Use New Project in the panel header when you need a separate project. Other video exports contain storyboard text/JSON and finished frames for editing and rendering in Premiere.

Generated images are saved directly for viewing and export. StoryTable does not run an additional AI visual inspection after generation. Opening an older project recovers saved images blocked solely by the former automatic review, while preserving revision history and locked or manually restored selections.

Instagram projects preserve the photo evidence cited by their selected direction. Previously affected linked projects repair copied-photo references before outline generation. Create & Refine keeps its main action buttons visible below the scrolling content.

Interview Edit Script projects derive their structure from the complete brief, outline, script, or prose guidance, with no fixed headings or section count. Analyze New Interviews searches interviews against every requested section without a fixed number of soundbites per section. Verified choices are saved after each search attempt. Candidates that cannot be verified are excluded from exports, listed in Interview Notes for review, and do not block the remaining interviews. A later analysis retries unresolved searches while preserving verified choices. Open Soundbite Map & EDL opens the separate audition map; Build Stringout assembles the finished film from saved research. Unsuccessful verification saves a draft with specific review notes. Continue Script Repair resumes that draft, including after closing StoryTable, without repeating completed research. Draft history and a copy of the previous cut are retained under book/interview-drafts. Changing the assignment or sources can require new research for affected inputs; existing research and draft histories remain on disk.

> *Current online copy: https://www.storytable.app/manual*

This manual describes the current installed Workspace, not the retired Classic screens. Its edition must match the StoryTable release that contains it. The same versioned PDF is packaged with the desktop app, attached to the public release, and published at the online address above.

Contents

Photo reading has its own model and reasoning setting in Settings' AI task table. It controls source-photo analysis, including visible text and factual interpretation. Art direction and visual references remains a separate task. Existing art-direction settings are preserved. Photo reading defaults to GPT-5.6 Terra with low reasoning; you can change it independently. This separates the tasks but does not guarantee a fixed response time or parallelize image reading.

To start with source material and discover what to make, choose New Project · Find Your Story · Instagram Strategy Desk. Add your transcripts or other sources, describe your audience and objective, then choose Find Strong Post Opportunities. Compare the concepts, their supporting excerpts, proposed formats and story beats; develop the ideas you want using each concept's format-specific action. You can develop more than one concept. Formats follow the material rather than being a choice you must make before analysis.

For an existing project, choose Explore Instagram Ideas from These Sources... under Source Documents, or Explore Instagram Ideas... in text review. This creates a separate strategy project with copies of your sources and preserves your existing project. Compatible completed source analysis is reused. Analysis starts when you choose the opportunity-finding action in that strategy project.

Complete carousel scripts in the Project Brief can become pages without another AI writing pass. A carousel project can also keep the full script in its single Primary source text file and use the brief for the introduction. Use numbered ## Episode 01 headings and numbered Card 1 - Dialogue: sections, with named dialogue lines such as Randy: "Exact words." and a Visual: direction for every card. Card 7 - Reveal: uses the same dialogue format; inline Copy cards are also supported. Choose Create Project Outline to preserve those supplied words, episode order, visual directions, and captions. Missing or duplicate numbers and incomplete cards are reported before existing pages are changed. Ordinary briefs continue through the normal AI planning workflow.

For an Instagram campaign architecture or coverage ledger, ask for that explicitly in the Project Brief. StoryTable plans the series before developing individual posts, preserves requested catalog coverage, and lists missing production assets and decisions separately from the plan.

If Instagram planning needs more direction, the completed recommendations and questions are saved in the project for you to review. Update the brief with your answers before continuing. Small plain-document collections are read directly; larger collections and timed interviews use the complete source-analysis workflow.

If source evaluation stops during evidence selection, StoryTable retains the completed transcript analysis. This interruption does not mean there are no usable content ideas. Run the same evaluation again to reuse the saved analysis and completed selections.

When graphics accompany an existing recording, StoryTable writes the graphic cards from the supplied brief, flyer and other evidence. The recording's placement stays in the production notes. Silent graphics do not require a spoken script, transcript or still frame. Exact recorded words are required when you request quotations or speech captions. The selected Instagram concept supplies editorial direction; requirements added by that suggestion do not override your brief.

Premiere transcript text exports may contain empty timed sections, including a time range with no speaker or dialogue. You can import these exports directly. StoryTable retains the source text and uses the spoken passages as evidence; empty sections do not become quotations.

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1. What StoryTable does

StoryTable is a source-grounded story-production workspace. It turns briefs, documents, interview transcripts, recordings, images, and reusable creative direction into an ordered plan that you can inspect before StoryTable writes, illustrates, or exports anything.

Use it to build social posts, presentations, illustrated pages, interview edit scripts, storyboards, articles, schedules, and other structured deliverables. StoryTable keeps the source evidence, editorial instructions, page plan, generated versions, and publication files connected instead of treating each AI request as an isolated prompt.

StoryTable is deliberately not a one-click black box. The important checkpoints are visible: review the source material, confirm the audience and goal, inspect the outline, verify exact quotations, approve page direction, and then create or export the result. AI-supported actions propose work for review; local verification protects exact transcript evidence and supplied-image pixels where the workflow requires them.

The normal Workspace workflow is:

1. Create a project from a brief, source document, Template, or existing project.
2. Use Plan to establish evidence, audience, goal, output direction, and the ordered Page Outline.
3. Use Create to generate the planned writing, imagery, or production assets.
4. Use Refine to edit, compare, regenerate, restore, skip, or lock work.
5. Use Publish to export a verified handoff package for the selected output.

StoryTable keeps user-created project files in a local folder that you choose. Reusable library definitions and protected application data are separate from project folders.

The evidence rule

StoryTable distinguishes source evidence from creative direction. A transcript, source document, project brief, or reviewed source image may establish facts. Goals, Writing Styles, Channels, Instruction Assistants, and text entered into an AI-direction dialog tell StoryTable what to do with those facts; they do not create new evidence.

When exact wording matters, keep it in Transcript Evidence, not only in Page Text. StoryTable can then verify that wording against an imported transcript, retain its speaker and time range, and reject an invented or paraphrased replacement. Always review the proposed selection in context before publishing.

Important terms

- Project brief: the editable source of truth used to plan the project.
- Page: one ordered unit of the result, such as a slide, carousel image, poster, or illustrated story page.
- Source document: supporting written material attached to the project.
- Primary source: the document StoryTable should treat as the central evidence source. TXT, Markdown, SRT, PDF, DOCX, CSV, and HTML documents can be marked primary in Plan; formats that do not use the legacy single-source slot remain fully available through the multi-document planner.

- Source image: an image StoryTable can read for visible text, meaning, facts, and caption ideas.
- Transcript evidence: exact source words, speaker, source file, and time range kept separate from authored page text.
- Soundbite: one verified quotation or an explicitly marked splice of same-speaker transcript segments.
- Script anchor: the exact user-authored objective, outline beat, heading, or script passage where a selected soundbite is meant to appear.
- Page reference: a supplied image attached to a particular page for provider-integrated unchanged use, faithful recreation in a selected style, or loose inspiration for new artwork.
- Faithful Reference Image: a Visual Style reference whose depicted subject remains recognizable when applying the selected rendering medium; it is used by default unless a specific page requirement clearly favors another supplied source.
- Current image: the active generated or supplied image version for a page.
- Needs Image Regeneration: the current image no longer matches an image-affecting page instruction.
- Locked: protected from replacement, regeneration, removal, and bulk image actions until explicitly unlocked.
- Skipped: excluded from Create Missing, Create Selected, and Create All without deleting image history.
- Revision: an immutable generated image version retained in the project.
- Library item: a reusable Template, Goal, Instruction Assistant, Deliverable, Channel, Writing Style, Brand, Visual Style, Layout, or Character.

2. Workspace at a glance

The left sidebar is divided into three areas.

The Active Library dropdown sits at the upper left, below the StoryTable logo and above Current Project. It stays available as you move between workspaces, with or without a project open.

Projects

- All Projects opens or creates projects.
- Recent shows recently used projects.
- New Project starts the guided project wizard.

Current Project

These destinations appear when a project is open:

- Overview
- Plan
- Create
- Refine
- Publish
- Files

Workspace

- Libraries
- Batch Projects
- Account & Usage
- Settings

Header and progress display

The header shows the project name, project readiness or warning state, account state, and Save.

An operation progress display stays near the top of the Workspace while work is running. A highlight moves across the bar so you can see that StoryTable is working even while a provider request is waiting. The current action and completed steps appear when available; an unknown total does not show an invented percentage. The same activity feedback appears in Library AI editors, AI writing and refinement, and the New Project wizard.

Source-based planning and opportunity discovery report four phases: preparing the project, reading and analyzing sources, building/checking the outline or opportunities, and saving the result. The phase heading stays visible alongside the current source/section detail. Provider queue and waiting messages appear separately instead of replacing that detail. Percentages describe progress within the current phase; a phase with an unknown duration keeps an activity indicator.

The Elapsed timer reports wall-clock time, including provider waits and any pauses. It freezes when the job finishes, before you spend time reviewing a result. Completed in, Failed after, or Stopped after remains visible with the final duration until another job starts. Job titles, outcomes, and durations are also recorded in StoryTable's support logs. Cancel is available during supported operations; Pause and Resume appear when the operation supports pausing. StoryTable prevents conflicting long-running operations from starting at the same time.

Hosted generation can take more than five minutes. While the service continues reporting that the task is queued or running, StoryTable follows the same task until it finishes. The moving highlight and elapsed timer stay active. The connection timeout limits individual network requests, not the full generation run.

Stop ends desktop waiting; the original hosted task may continue. StoryTable preserves its identity for a later status check. See An operation was interrupted for stopping and reconnecting.

Hosted AI failures retain their specific explanation and support reference. A message that a credit reservation was released does not mean your account has insufficient credits. Account Usage is suggested only for an actual balance shortfall. Completed source-analysis sections remain saved and can be reused when you repeat the unchanged Editorial Desk request. The failed final synthesis may require a new AI request.

Buttons with the OpenAI logo submit an AI-supported action and may consume account credits. Buttons without the logo perform local or non-AI actions.

Context-aware work areas

StoryTable uses the active project's resolved Goal, Deliverable, Template, Channel, source material, and current page to decide which specialized work areas apply. A specialist work area that does not apply is removed from the layout, so you do not have to scroll past controls intended for another kind of project.

- Lyric & Motion Details appears only for lyric interpretation, timed lyric

video or motion/storyboard outputs, or a page explicitly classified as lyric/kinetic/motion/storyboard.

- Transcript Evidence and the soundbite tools appear only when StoryTable

recognizes actual transcript provenance: an SRT, a transcribed recording, a transcript- or interview-labeled source, a transcript-specific workflow with attached sources, or an explicit primary text transcript. Ordinary PDFs, DOCX or background notes, and compatibility text extracted from a PDF do not enable them. Name Speakers appears only after speakers have been detected.

- Structured Event Poster fields have equivalent event/poster gating.
- Text-only outputs hide visual identity, artwork direction, page-photo, and

character controls. Their Plan labels change from presentation and page-plan language to writing and document language.

- Editorial Desk replaces the ordinary Plan phases with its own

transcript, Coverage Brief, and story-opportunity workspace while that Goal is active.

3. Quick start

Create, generate, and publish a simple project

1. Choose New Project.
2. Select Write a project brief.
3. Enter what StoryTable should create, including verified facts, goals, priorities, and exclusions.
4. Choose Next.
5. Name the project, choose its local save location, and choose an output type.
6. Identify the audience and destination.
7. Choose writing, visual, brand, size, orientation, and text-in-image direction.
8. Review the summary and create the project.
9. StoryTable opens Plan. Review the project brief and direction.
10. Build or edit the Page Outline.
11. Save the plan.
12. Open Create and choose Generate Page Text if pages do not yet exist.
13. Review the pages, then choose Create Missing Images, Create Selected Images, or Create All Images.
14. Open Refine to edit, regenerate, compare, or lock images.
15. Open Publish, review the package preview, choose a destination, and select Export Publication Package.

Start from interviews or a recording

1. Create the project and open Plan.
2. Choose Add Documents for existing transcripts, or Transcribe Recording... for an audio or video file.
3. For a recording, review the generated timestamped SRT and use Name Speakers... when detected speaker labels should be replaced with real names.
4. Set every interview's Purpose to Interview transcript so the interviews are considered as peers. Use Background/context for material that must not supply quotes, and Excluded for files that must not be used. Add source-specific evidence instructions in the notes.
5. Set the Goal, Deliverable, audience, Channel, Writing Style, and any duration or required-content constraints.
6. Create or update the Page Outline. StoryTable analyzes every included transcript in full before assembling the story. Follow the source/section progress and review how the interviews are interwoven; peer treatment does not promise equal screen time.
7. On an exact-quote page, choose Find Another Soundbite... beside Page Text to request a different source-grounded quotation without inventing or paraphrasing words.
8. Review the proposed quote, speaker name, transcript filename, time range, and exact transcript match before applying it. A splice shows this attribution separately for every component.

4. Create a project

Choose New Project in the sidebar or File > New Project. The wizard uses the currently selected Active Library, so its Templates, Goals, Deliverables, Channels, Writing Styles, Instruction Assistants, Visual Styles, Brands, Layouts, and Characters come from the same reusable Library profile you see in Libraries.

Step 1: Find Your Story

"Upload text documents, photos, or audio files. StoryTable will analyze your materials and suggest different stories you could tell. Choose a story to develop." The first screen offers four large cards: Content Opportunity Finder, Editorial

Desk, Evergreen Content Finder, and Instagram Strategy Desk. Choose one to continue with that setup. The All preset types filter sits immediately below the four cards and takes you to the matching preset choices.

In Tell us where you want to begin, write your assignment in the long-form box and choose Suggest Starting Points. StoryTable recommends available Library Goals and presets, shows up to six likely choices, and explains why each fits. Choose a recommendation to continue with that setup, or choose Use My Brief... to configure your own project. Your full text becomes the editable Project Brief; selecting another preset does not replace or shorten it.

Browse All Goals and Presets... searches the complete active Library catalog, including your own Goals and presets. Starting with images does not restrict which projects you can choose. An image-only upload immediately suggests common options without an AI request. Suggest Starting Points can then use a photo overview to suggest options from the actual images. Photo Collage creates one graphic from the supplied images; no transcript is needed.

You can also drop transcripts, documents, PDFs, photos, or folders into Drop your source materials here. Adding files starts a quick match using document excerpts and a photo overview. Suggestions identify the number of sources previewed; all attached files carry into the project, including files outside that preview. Add files from several folders to the same collection. The prompt box stays available to explain what you want from those sources. Change your brief and choose Suggest Starting Points to update the matches. The view brings the resulting choices into sight when they are ready.

This first match helps choose a workflow. The selected discovery workspace then performs its fuller source analysis. A PDF dropped here is source material; it does not automatically create one output page per PDF page.

Further down, Choose your own starting point retains Start with a Preset, the document and photo shortcuts, and custom project setup.

Start from an existing document

Choose a plain-text, Markdown, or text-based PDF source. StoryTable validates the file before continuing.

- Image-only PDFs are not accepted as primary text sources.
- This direct-document shortcut is narrower than the source drop area above,

which also accepts DOCX, CSV, HTML, SRT, and calendar documents.

- The selected source is copied into the new project.

Write a project brief

Write the editable project brief directly.

The Project brief is durable project evidence and direction: what the project should accomplish, verified facts, required content, priorities, and exclusions.

The adjacent Optional AI direction is temporary writing guidance, such as "make this concise," "organize it chronologically," or "preserve every supplied name and date." It is treated as direction rather than verified evidence and is not saved as part of the project. Put project facts in the Project brief.

Use Write with AI to request a draft or improvement. StoryTable returns a suggestion for review; it does not silently replace your brief.

Write with AI must use the shortest clear, complete operational instructions. Drafting and review remove repetition and boilerplate, using standard terms, numerals and unambiguous abbreviations when meaning survives. Required details, source roles, exclusions and exact display text remain. Length targets are advisory; neither inputs nor suggestions are cut off. You can request additions. Finished articles, invitations and other audience-facing copy retain their requested voice and length, using readable prose.

To share saved story proposals, choose Export Proposals... in Create & Refine, select All document sections, then Export Text Document. The export folder contains a printable PDF alongside editable Markdown and plain text. This

exports the saved proposals, rather than the initial project starting-point suggestions.

In the Premiere panel, open Story Proposals and choose Export Proposals as PDF... to save every proposal, or Export This Proposal as PDF... on one card. Choose the file's destination in the Save dialog. PDFs include the complete saved proposal and its evidence and production details; no story development or AI request is needed to export.

Start with a template

Choose a reusable project Preset. The first screen groups recommended starting points; choose Browse All Presets... when you need the complete installed collection. Presets appear with thumbnail previews or a deterministic fallback preview. The template supplies starting choices that remain reviewable in the wizard and editable in the project.

Use Filter presets by type to see Find Your Story, Instagram & Social, Video & Audio, Presentations & Pitches, Teaching & Guides, Events & Promotion, Stories & Articles, or Other & Custom. Research presets produce a written report and suggested projects without requiring a production Deliverable first.

Scroll over closed selectors to move the surrounding view without changing a choice. Open a selector or use the keyboard to change it. Lists and tables scroll by pixels so tall document rows remain accessible. A clipped prompt scrolls into view before its contents scroll; reaching an inner scroll boundary continues in the surrounding view.

When a Template is selected, the next steps begin with that Template's stored Goal, Deliverable, Audience, Channel, Writing Style, Visual Style, Brand, dimensions, orientation, and context defaults. For example, Event Poster Set starts with the source-driven Graphic Set Deliverable, while Classroom Lesson starts with Students in a classroom as its audience and Classroom as its destination. Changing a choice in the wizard creates a project override; it does not silently rewrite the reusable Template.

For a grouped birthday roster, choose Event Poster Set and state the grouping rule in the Project Brief. StoryTable parses the complete source locally, groups students by month and day, and creates the exact source-driven page count before creative generation. Each supplied name and grade is placed exactly once. Groups larger than ten names are divided as evenly as possible across clearly labeled continuation graphics. This roster pagination does not use hosted AI or credits; AI is used only for later creative work such as artwork generation.

Duplicate an existing project

Choose a .story file, project.json, or a StoryTable project folder. StoryTable creates a separate copy rather than editing the selected source project in place.

Step 2: Describe the desired result

Set:

- Project name
- Save location
- Output type

Output choices use visual previews where available.

The save location is the parent folder for the new local project. StoryTable does not overwrite an occupied project folder; it chooses a safe versioned name when necessary.

Step 3: Choose the audience, channel, and size

Describe who should understand or use the result and where they will experience it. These choices shape wording, supporting content, accessibility, discovery, attention, and expected format.

On Audience, Channel and Size, choose Size / aspect ratio and Orientation. Resulting size shows the actual width ×

height in pixels and ratio, including portrait dimensions. These controls appear in both Simple and Advanced setup. Square formats need no orientation choice. Channel and deliverable recommendations apply until you explicitly choose dimensions; your choices then stay in place as you move between setup steps.

For the included social destinations, the destination actively shapes the build plan. Instagram Feed, Instagram Reels, LinkedIn, TikTok, and YouTube use separate rules for source selection, openings and endings, image and visible-text density, caption or script responsibilities, safe areas, and writing-style adaptation. A verified publishing limit is treated as a constraint; a suggested card, frame, image, or word count is identified as StoryTable editorial guidance rather than a performance guarantee. Writing Style supplies the voice within those platform rules. Visual Style decorates and unifies the content without choosing the content or increasing its density. Existing social outputs refresh to the current built-in profile when opened.

Templates supply editable starting values for both fields. Changing them for a new project does not alter the reusable Template.

Step 4: Set voice and visual direction

Choose or review:

- Writing Style
- Visual Style
- Brand
- Visual reference images and their intended influence
- Whether words appear inside generated images
- Advanced project direction

Library-backed selectors show active items from the selected Library. Saved Library categories appear as disabled dropdown headings; they organize the choices but cannot be selected as values. Removed Library items stay hidden, while unavailable choices already saved inside an existing project remain visible enough for the project to open and be reviewed.

Use Create Brand to create a reusable brand without leaving the wizard. The Brand dialog includes logos, brand imagery, a preview, color swatches, typography, font family, and usage guidance. Color extraction is an explicit Extract Colors from Images action; uploading a logo alone does not indicate that extraction has run.

The words-in-images choices are:

- Automatic: StoryTable shows or hides text in artwork automatically.
- Always: generated artwork should include planned words.
- Never: generated artwork should not contain planned words.

Step 5: Review

Review the complete project setup before creating it. The wizard can also save the selected choices as a reusable Template, including a portable preview.

After creation, StoryTable opens Plan so the source of truth and page outline can be reviewed before generation.

5. All Projects and Overview

All Projects

Use All Projects to:

- Create a new project.

- Open an existing project.
- Open a recent project card.
- Choose Remove on a project card to hide it from StoryTable without

deleting its folder or files.

Opening an existing project takes you to Overview.

A removed project can be shown again with Open Project. Select its project folder; opening it restores the project to All Projects and Recent.

Overview

Overview summarizes:

- Project brief
- Source-document count
- Source-image count
- Destination
- Page count
- Current images
- Images needing regeneration
- Locked images
- Failed images
- Blocking issues
- Recent export history

The suggested next action changes with project readiness. For a newly created project with no pages, the meaningful next step is normally in Plan or Generate Page Text.

6. Plan

Plan is where you tell StoryTable what the project means and how each page should work. It writes and edits the outline; it does not generate final images.

One source, multiple outputs

Every project starts with one output. In Plan > section 4 (Build), choose Another Version... beside Choose What to Make... when the same source material should become another channel or deliverable. Expand the Build section, then select the channel, deliverable, Size / aspect ratio, and Orientation. Check the resulting pixel dimensions, name the audience and objective, then choose Create Version.

By default, Start with the current page plan and assigned source images is selected. The new output begins with the current pages, words, captions, source-image assignments, and saved source-image analysis. Page dimensions use your selected size and orientation, while generated artwork is left empty so StoryTable does not reuse an image made for the wrong dimensions. Clear the option only when the new output should start with no page plan. Project Brief, source documents, source images, and their analysis always remain shared project material. After creation, each output's plan and artwork can be edited independently. Repeat to add further outputs.

Only one named output is shown and edited at a time. Each output keeps its own channel, deliverable, audience, delivery strategy, outline, photo selection, page order, words, captions, artwork, and revision state.

Choose Build Output Plans to rebuild every output's outline in one operation. This replaces existing outlines but does not create artwork. Choose What to Make... shows the selected output's objective and the delivery strategy StoryTable

derives from its audience, channel, and deliverable.

Focus for this output appears beside the selected output and can be edited in Choose What to Make.... It defines that output's subject and assignment. Shared project instructions still supply context, factual corrections, and exclusions. A proposal previously added with Use Approach in Brief... does not redirect another selected idea to the earlier topic. The original shared brief and report remain saved. If an older version already generated the wrong topic, select the affected output and choose Rebuild This Output Plan to replace that draft using its own focus; the opportunity report does not need rebuilding.

To resize an existing output, open Plan > section 4 (Build) and use Size and Orientation directly below the output selector and actions. The same controls are available in Choose What to Make.... Plan saves these choices automatically; the dialog uses Save Result Settings. Changes apply only to the selected output. Saved artwork remains available, but images made for the previous dimensions need to be recreated to use the new size.

Map transcript soundbites to a script or outline

Use Map Transcript Soundbites by Story Function when you already know the video's objective, outline, or working script and need exact interview passages placed against it.

1. Select Map Transcript Soundbites by Story Function as the Goal and Interview Edit Script as the Deliverable.
2. Put the intended viewer result and ordered outline or script in the Project Brief. Keep the anchor wording and order explicit. If the script is a file, attach it as Background/context so it directs placement but cannot be mistaken for interview speech.
3. Add every quote-bearing transcript and mark each one Interview transcript.
4. Choose Create Page Outline or Update Page Outline. StoryTable reads the included transcripts, verifies candidate wording locally, and maps each selected passage to the anchor where its cinematic or literary function is strongest.
5. In Create & Refine, review the script/outline anchor, story function, verified source, placement rationale, and any functionally distinct alternate soundbites. Review uncovered anchors as reporting or writing gaps rather than accepting a merely topical quotation.
6. In Publish, choose Export Soundbite Map to export the inline map, source record, alternatives, gaps, and associated editorial handoff files.

Choose Assemble an Interview Edit Script instead when the transcripts should lead StoryTable to discover the controlling idea and construct the narrative arc.

Bring Premiere transcripts into StoryTable and return a rough cut

The StoryTable application starts its Premiere connection service automatically. Keep StoryTable running, choose Premiere > Connection to locate the pairing file, then choose Connect StoryTable in Bridge 0.3.4 and select that file. Both interfaces share the same project workspace. In the Bridge, follow Sources > Story Beats > Review Rough Cut > Premiere Sequence. Review and save the beats, build the rough cut, then choose Prepare Premiere Sequence and review timing before Create New Sequence.

StoryTable can read source packages from StoryTable Bridge for Premiere. In Add Source Documents or Add Transcript Files, select the exported batch-manifest.json to add all successful clips, or select individual .storytable.json packages. StoryTable preserves the original exports and imports their speakers, readable words, timestamps and original media identities. Reimporting unchanged material avoids duplicates; a new revision updates the active transcript and retains the earlier package.

In Interview Edit Script, choose Analyze New Interviews to save findings and candidate excerpts without changing your edit. Open Interview Notes shows the saved notes. Add interviews as they arrive and analyze again to process new or changed sources. Choose Build Stringout or Rebuild Stringout when ready to assemble the saved evidence against the brief. Build identifies missing analysis rather than silently running it. Changes to analysis direction or source content can require fresh analysis. Completed compatible 408 analyses are reused.

Premiere word cues are grouped into readable passages for analysis. Original words, disfluencies, and timings remain unchanged. Export verifies full reviewed excerpts exactly and never substitutes a shorter fuzzy match.

Use Interview Edit Script to select and order verified excerpts. Its Export package includes premiere-edit-plan.storytable.json when the selected excerpts are backed by Premiere packages. In StoryTable Bridge 0.2.1, choose Open StoryTable EditPlan, review the excerpts and verify each source's timing mapping, then choose Create New Sequence. The bridge creates a separate rough cut using the original media. Transfers are manual; importing a transcript does not start paid generation or retranscription.

This first sequence builder is a development feature for Premiere 26.5 or later. It supports matching integer 24, 25, 30, 50 or 60 fps sources with linked audio and video. Mixed/fractional rates, variable frame rates, retimed footage and audio-only sources are not yet supported. Verify speech timing at both ends of each source before confirming its mapping. Play through the result before saving. If Premiere reports a failure, inspect the partial sequence before retrying.

Disfluencies and pauses inside selected excerpts remain in the audio. Blank disfluency entries supplied by Premiere stay in the original data; StoryTable does not invent words or insert placeholders for them. There is no automatic filler-word removal or silence trimming.

Discover outputs from a source collection

Use the Content Opportunity Finder when you have a collection of source documents, often several transcripts, and want StoryTable to identify useful things the material could become before you choose a format.

1. Start with the Content Opportunity Finder Template.
2. Add the source documents. Mark quote-bearing transcripts as Interview transcript, supporting material as Background/context, and anything StoryTable must ignore as Excluded.
3. Use the Project Brief for any specific audience, campaign priority, constraint, or desired result. The active Library Context supplies the organization's mission, values, audiences, editorial priorities, and sensitivities as a relevance lens; it never supplies missing story facts.
4. Choose Find Content Opportunities. StoryTable reads the complete included source collection and proposes the distinct, strong options it supports, ranked strongest first, with twenty per report as a practical ceiling.
5. Review each option's source focus, Template, Goal, Deliverable, Channel, Writing Style, Brand, and short reason. These are setup opportunities, not publishable pages or artwork.
6. Results open in Plan > 4. Choose and Build Outputs. Check one or more opportunities, then choose Build Selected Ideas directly above the list. The button displays the selected count and becomes available after a selection.

From Review Content Opportunities, Choose and Build Outputs opens that same selection area. Source Material for This Idea shows the saved source focus and project sources; if no exact quotation or timecode is attached, it says so. The first idea is listed by its actual name even when its text also contains the report's research summary. More Opportunity Actions offers another discovery run or report export.

Each selection becomes an independent output setup. Use the output selector in the same Build section to switch among the report and created outputs. The Project Brief, source documents, source images, and analysis remain

shared. The Router's opportunity cards are not copied into the new outputs. StoryTable begins building an outline for each selected idea and keeps the written research report. Refreshing the Router later does not change outputs that were already set up.

Find Evergreen Content Angles

Use Evergreen Content Finder to rank source-supported content that can remain useful beyond the current event or news cycle. Its workspace focuses on source material, instructions, feedback, and opportunities.

1. Choose the Evergreen Content Finder Preset, name the Finder, and choose its save location. New-project setup skips visual and page settings.

2. Add documents or transcribe recordings. Review source roles & instructions lets you control inclusion and per-source guidance. Add or review source photos opens the existing source-image analysis and review controls. Analyze and apply image evidence before relying on it for discovery.

3. Optionally use Discovery Brief for the audience, recurring needs, number of angles, time horizon, and likely future uses. Guidance & Feedback collects priorities, exclusions, and revisions to earlier recommendations. Both save automatically. The saved Library context informs relevance and ranking without becoming story evidence.

4. Choose Find Evergreen Opportunities. Review each ranked angle's premise, audience need, shelf life, evidence, reuse suggestions, update-dependent details, and reporting gaps. Weak or unsupported directions appear under Angles Not Recommended. Earlier saved reports remain readable; rerun discovery to obtain selectable cards.

5. Choose Create Project from This Angle to create a separately saved project using the recommended native Preset. Original included sources and their roles, image evidence, and editorial guidance carry forward. The assignment is direction, not an additional source. A proposed outline is built before artwork. An angle marked Needs additional reporting offers Create Research Project and opens for resolving evidence gaps before generation.

6. Open Project reopens an existing linked project. Return to Evergreen Content Finder brings you back to the ranked list. Save Opportunity Report exports the findings as a plain-text document without generating artwork.

In Create & Refine, the Page Images card also shows How to use these images. Preserve supplied images requires the photographed people, clothing, and scene to remain unchanged while the surrounding design follows the selected style. Recreate in the selected style redraws the same subjects; Use as inspiration permits new imagery. This is the same saved page choice used in Plan. Changing it keeps existing revisions and marks current artwork for regeneration; it does not immediately regenerate the image.

Change the Layout of One Page

Select a page in Create & Refine and open Layout & Placement. Choose Automatic for a varied arrangement, or put its text on the left, right, top or bottom. The small diagram shows text space in dark blue. These choices apply to this page; the reusable Library Layout stays available.

For an interview, optionally choose the subject's side. Automatic places text opposite a reported left or right subject. With the subject-position choice set to Automatic, supplied photos or frames guide the image model. A transcript alone cannot show the camera framing. When no frame is supplied, Automatic varies the arrangement across the set. Brand colors and typography remain in effect.

Choices save automatically when you switch pages. Regenerate the selected page to apply a changed layout to its artwork. Existing images and approved copy remain saved. Words baked into a generated image require a new render

to move.

In the Premiere panel, Layout & Text Placement provides the same choices. Each planned narration image can override the set's placement and subject side. Review lists these choices before generation. Use Change Layout on a saved image to open a revision for that image. The original remains saved. To use the current footage as framing guidance, position the playhead and use Capture Current Frame as a subject reference. Editable titles added with Premiere's text tools can still be positioned directly in Premiere.

For marker-based narration illustrations, write design notes in the selected duration markers' Comments. StoryTable carries each comment into the visual direction for that section and shows its marker name and original note in the plan. Edit the visual direction before reviewing the cost. Comments stay separate from the recorded words. Overlapping markers keep each spoken word once and apply the notes only within their marked ranges; markers of other colors are excluded. Blank comments retain the normal illustration workflow.

Build a video edit from clips and a brief in Premiere

Choose Build a Video Edit. Import the clips you want to use and describe what the video should communicate. You can paste a post, article, script or outline to guide an event recap or interview story. StoryTable uses the text for messages and themes and selects spoken lines from the recordings. You do not need to choose a Goal or Preset for this path.

Review the selected passages, then create a new Premiere sequence. When using the Project Goal view, Use this brief for a video edit carries over the brief and imported clips. Its Create button starts from the sources listed on screen; there is no separate source-confirmation checkbox. If the sources actually change before starting, the updated list appears for review and the brief is retained.

Project Goal results that contain recorded excerpts offer Prepare Premiere Sequence. When some sections have no recorded excerpt, Prepare Available Soundbites assembles the available passages and lists the omitted sections. It leaves the original plan intact. An additional presenter recording is a suggestion for a line that was not selected from the existing recordings, and is not inserted as if it already exists. Supplied guest names or facts can also be used for on-screen introductions when appropriate.

New Project > Browse All Goals & Presets includes the complete active Library, including your own workflows. Video suggestions appear first. For a Goal without a chosen Preset, choose its Deliverable. Product Campaign shows fields for the product's name, facts and reference images before creation.

Video Publishing: titles, descriptions and thumbnails

Open Export > Video Publishing in a video project. The current destination is YouTube. This creates a publishing output inside the existing project; the video plan and its folder remain available. The existing YouTube Packaging Preset also opens this tool. It replaces the earlier YouTube Thumbnail preset name.

1. In Premiere, choose Use active sequence or Use selected Premiere sequence.

StoryTable reads the sequence's native transcript when available. Otherwise it uses available clip transcripts within the edited sequence ranges. Unused interview material is excluded. If no usable transcript is available, choose the mode for describing the video and answer What is this video about?. No separate SRT export is required. In the desktop app, Use This Video Plan uses the current ordered pages as the intended video; use Premiere to package the actual finished edit.

2. Optionally add a working title, photographs, artwork, captured frames, Brand

or visual style. Check which reference images StoryTable may use. Images can be independent photographs and do not need to come from the video.

3. Anything you'd like to emphasize? (optional) lets you steer audience, tone,

required wording or exclusions. Leave it blank to use the video and Library context. The task already includes publishing copy and thumbnail design.

4. Choose one, two or three Thumbnail options; the default is two. Keep

Include publishing title and caption/description selected for the complete package. Choose Create Publishing Package, then review the designs and their reasons. Review the image estimate before generating their artwork. Refine generated images in Create & Refine.

5. Edit Publishing title and Caption / description, select Thumbnail for

publishing, and save the publishing copy. Export the package ZIP or the selected thumbnail. The ZIP includes title.txt, description.txt, thumbnail.jpg, youtube-package.json and any completed alternative thumbnails.

Teach an organization's title convention in Library Context, alongside its editorial guidance. State the pattern and give accepted examples, such as SAR Academy | {Event} | {Speaker}. StoryTable follows that convention using facts from the selected video. A direction entered for this video can override the convention. Missing names or dates must not be invented to fill placeholders. Publishing titles are limited to 100 characters and descriptions to 5,000. Thumbnail wording normally uses up to eight words; exact wording explicitly requested is retained. Planned content is not represented as footage already filmed.

In Premiere, the publishing tool can apply the saved title and description to the active sequence's metadata and queue that sequence in Media Encoder. It checks that the active sequence is the one packaged. Refreshing the packaged source requires rebuilding its publishing copy before these actions. Media Encoder's YouTube Publish fields are separate from sequence metadata: use the copy controls and exported thumbnail to fill them, review the account and visibility, then start the queue. Queuing alone does not upload the video.

The prior YouTube Thumbnail A/B Set Deliverable remains available. Previously saved configurations retain their existing behavior.

Plan an Instagram Post

Each authored card or frame includes its purpose alongside the visible copy, visual direction and production notes. If an older draft was stopped solely because its labelled purpose was stored in production notes, retrying the outline recovers that saved metadata and reviews the same draft. It preserves the original copy, source references, audit and revision budget. Completed recovery is reused on subsequent retries.

Source-reference failures identify the rejected source location and exact problem for the repair step. Repairs prioritize these evidence problems before optional editorial changes. An older stopped run whose repair step never received those findings may resume using only its remaining revision attempts.

Large Instagram source collections use a bounded evidence request. When the original transcripts fit, StoryTable sends their exact words and locators once instead of duplicating them with the derived analysis. Larger collections use the saved complete-corpus analysis, selected exact passages and all evidence referenced by the current draft. Complete originals remain available for local verification. If the combined brief and evidence still exceed the request limit, StoryTable stops before submitting that oversized request and retains the saved analysis and prior plan.

Choose the Instagram Strategy Desk Preset. Add what you have and describe what you want to happen. You do not need to choose a strategy name or write a detailed prompt. Existing saved reports remain readable with their original recipe definitions.

1. Add source documents or images, or begin with a brief. Under What do you want

to happen?, describe the result in ordinary language: for example, help local parents understand the teaching or encourage event registrations. Include any specific audience, format, voice, deadline or production limits you want kept.

2. Choose Find Strong Post Opportunities. StoryTable reads the material, labels useful

assumptions, and asks only consequential unresolved questions. It separates evidence support, strategic fit and production readiness. A missing example, contradictory date or unsupported claim can lead to a request for more material instead of a forced recommendation.

3. Review distinct source-supported opportunities, ranked strongest first, with

up to twenty per report when the material warrants it. Each shows what to make, why it fits, the intended result, an opening and outline, tradeoffs, and remaining dependencies. Show evidence and decision details opens the supporting source map and editorial fit scores.

4. Choose Build This, or include several directions and choose Build Selected

Posts. If you want StoryTable to decide and proceed, check Choose the strongest direction and build it for me before recommending. A direct current instruction such as "You choose the approach and build it" also delegates that choice. Prepare Source Brief keeps missing evidence explicit.

5. Each selected direction receives a linked project with source copies, audience,

voice and guidance. Open Project reuses that project; Return to Instagram Strategy Desk reopens the recommendations. Try a Different Angle requests another supported approach. Save Opportunities saves a readable report.

Each recommendation must offer a concrete source moment, an editorial angle and a reason viewers would care. General praise or a value word on a graphic is not enough. The desk explores individual stories and meaningful connections across interviews; it chooses formats to serve those ideas.

The complete draft includes audience-facing copy, publishing caption where appropriate, visual directions, source references and production dependencies. Carousels have exact card copy and alt text. Reels have a proposed timed script, on-screen copy, subtitles and a footage plan; they are storyboards, not finished videos. Story frames keep native poll, question and link instructions separate from artwork. Rendering and publishing remain separate actions.

Every draft receives source and instruction checks before editorial scoring. The bounded review keeps exact versions, permits at most three revision attempts, and stops after two attempts fail to improve the work. A strong initial draft does not require rewriting. The result may be ready for your review, need source material or a decision, or need editorial review. An internal score is not a performance forecast or audience test.

Use Apply Feedback and Review Draft for changes such as "less salesy" or "make card 2 about the student." Unaffected cards and publishing fields stay protected during that review. Later manual edits change the review banner to show that the current wording has not yet been reviewed. New explicit feedback can start a new bounded run; retrying an unchanged completed run does not reset its revision allowance.

Record or Review Published Results accepts observations you supply. Keep the actual metric name, count, reach or relevant Story-frame viewers, reporting window, and evidence source. Missing or zero denominators produce no rate. The review distinguishes observations from possible explanations and proposes one next experiment. Results are saved in this project; this is not an analytics connection or automatic account-wide learning.

View Strategy Reference explains the twenty v1.4 playbooks, minimum evidence, authoring steps, rejection rules and useful measurements. Collaboration, recurring series and search are supporting methods on a substantive post. When you supply recording transcripts, StoryTable assumes you have the originals unless you say otherwise. You do not need to upload the media to receive Reel or excerpt-edit recommendations. Clip matching, media checks and editing are later production steps; missing evidence still cannot become a fact. Publication permission, accepted collaborators and functioning links remain real dependencies. StoryTable does not claim live trend research or guaranteed reach.

Goals are organized into Instagram, Research & Discovery, Video & Audio, Teaching & Guides, Campaigns & Social, Events & Schedules, Stories & Articles, and General categories. Instagram contains the twenty strategy Goals plus planning and general post development. Existing custom categories are preserved. Move Goals into your own categories in Library.

Create a Product Campaign

Choose New Project · Product Campaign to promote your own product or service. Upload product documents or enter its facts, then add product photos or software screenshots. Choose the audience, writing voice, and format: a five-card carousel, single post, or short-video storyboard. StoryTable drafts the message and scenes from that information. Review the draft before creating images.

Messaging pattern and Buyer motivation are independent. Combine Before-After-Bridge, Problem-Agitate-Solution, AIDA, 4 Ps, FAB, ACCA, QUEST, PASTOR, Star-Story-Solution, or Hook-Story-Offer with the reason your buyers care. Each framework develops a specific situation for the selected customer, shows how the product's documented capabilities help, and uses the selected Writing Style throughout. StoryTable develops ten competing campaign arguments, each with an opening and the complete sequence through the product moment and payoff. It first rejects misleading, unsupported, irrelevant or undelivered promises. Eligible hooks are judged for clarity, concrete detail, relevance, curiosity, credible payoff, novelty, economy, audience language, platform fit and continuation, with penalties for cliches and similar ideas. Selection compares tradeoffs and the weakest essentials rather than adding marks into one score. It retains up to four different ideas and creates two targeted revisions of each. Eligible originals and revisions compete again; an early favorite does not eliminate the other approaches. The finished draft is also checked for a coherent opening, progression, captions and ending. This adds preparation time and AI usage. Completed rounds are saved so interrupted work can resume. Scores are editorial judgments, not measured audience results.

If no concept qualifies, StoryTable uses the rejection reasons to create new, corrected concepts and independently reviews them before proceeding. This is limited to two correction rounds per selection stage; unsupported claims never advance just because they have a strong hook. Completed work remains saved. Product documentation supports capability claims, while a screenshot supports the item and interface state actually visible. A setup screen must not be passed off as completed results, but it may accompany a documented benefit of the tool shown. Older unfinished campaigns blocked by that distinction reuse their saved concepts when the brief, sources and settings still match, with a fresh review.

Edit Campaign Instructions changes the shared direction and whether to show life without the product. Use for New Campaigns saves your choices as defaults. These public campaign defaults are separate from private Library announcement defaults.

Choose Product only to make scenes without characters, or Use my own characters to add descriptions and optional reference images of your people or mascots. The project copies the supplied files and keeps the cast consistent while varying actions and framing. StoryTable's promotional mascots are not supplied to customer campaigns. Manage your cast later in Plan · Characters.

Every carousel includes the product naturally in the scene. Software screenshots guide an illustrated interface within the story; physical-product photos guide its appearance. Supplied facts support the copy, without invented offers or capabilities. A short-video output is a storyboard, not a rendered video.

After setup, Messaging and campaign instructions appears directly on Plan, above the collapsible project sections. Change the pattern or motivation there; changes save automatically. Choose Update Campaign Draft to rewrite this output's words and scene plan with those choices, then create the updated images. The status beside the controls tells you when the draft needs updating. Previous drafts and image versions are retained. Changing a dropdown alone does not rewrite pages you already reviewed.

Private StoryTable Library announcements use the owner's saved Lion (Randy), Tiger (Liz) and Sufie profiles. Either Randy or Liz leads each ad; the chosen lead stays consistent within that ad. Sufie is a supporting dog, without dialogue or human product-use actions. The other adult is optional, and Sufie can be omitted from an image when her inclusion exceeds its request limit. Catalog thumbnails do not create characters or serve as their identity references. Page cast choices and the named model sheets control the artwork.

Run an Editorial Desk

1. Choose New Project · Editorial Desk, name the project and choose its save location. The preset selects the Run an Editorial Desk Goal.
2. Use Add Documents... for this week's CSV, articles or transcripts. At least one complete, readable source document is required before analysis can begin. Transcribe a Recording... accepts audio or video. Review sources & instructions opens source roles and notes. Use Primary source for the response sheet and Interview transcript for recorded speech that can supply quotations. Background material guides context without supplying quotes.
3. Enter the complete assignment once in Coverage Brief, including required sections, length, audience and exclusions. Editorial Guidance & Feedback holds optional additional directions. Both save automatically.
4. Select the finished Output format in its separate control. This choice carries into the build and survives revisions to the brief.
5. Choose Find Story Opportunities. Review the evidence-supported options. For a publication with a selectable feature and fixed sections, the options supply the feature choice while the original brief retains the whole issue.
6. Choose Build project with this story on the desired option. The complete assignment, all included sources, selected story and saved format are used together to create actual pages in this project. No second brief is required.
7. Review the pages and image estimate. For a visual output, approve the estimate to render artwork or cancel to edit pages and attach photos first. Use Build Project... when ready. Use image as-is in styled layout preserves original photographs while the surrounding design uses your visual style.
8. Back to story choices returns to the options without rerunning discovery. Existing older commissioned projects retain their Open Story Project links.

StoryTable saves completed transcript analysis before it assembles the final assignment desk. The final synthesis can use the selected model's full supported output allowance, including its reasoning, and StoryTable automatically retries one confirmed hosted length-limit failure with more concise desk instructions. That retry reuses the saved transcript catalog; it does not resend completed transcript sections. If the desk still cannot finish, the existing project and any previous desk remain unchanged.

If hosted synthesis completes but StoryTable is interrupted before applying the desk, run the same unchanged Find Story Opportunities action. The saved task is checked and its completed result is applied without starting or charging for another generation. Keep the transcript collection, Coverage Brief, and generation settings unchanged until recovery finishes so StoryTable can identify the original request.

Project brief

The project brief is the editable source of truth. Put confirmed facts, chronology, required messages, goals, exclusions, and other story-wide direction here.

Supporting files remain separate. A source document's purpose and notes help StoryTable understand its role, but do not automatically make every statement in that document a verified fact.

Source documents

Choose Add Documents to attach project evidence and context. Plan accepts:

- TXT
- Markdown
- SRT subtitles and transcripts
- text-based PDF
- DOCX
- CSV
- HTML or HTM
- ICS, ICAL, IFB, or VCS calendar files

The table records each document, its Purpose, instructions for How StoryTable should use it, and document actions. Files are copied into the project. Use Interview transcript for each interview that may supply exact quotes. Every included interview is considered as a peer; this does not require equal screen time. Primary source identifies one lead document when that is appropriate. Importing multiple timed transcripts together assigns them the Interview transcript role automatically; check the role for untimed text.

Background/context and Writing Style reference can guide planning but cannot supply soundbites. Excluded prevents a document from entering planning or quote searches. Changing a formerly primary document to another role clears its obsolete primary assignment. A CSV, DOCX, HTML, or calendar file may also serve as the primary document.

What each Purpose means

- Interview transcript reads the full interview in transcript-specific workflows and permits exact, source-verified soundbites.
- Supporting source supplies secondary evidence and context. It is not the lead document and does not activate transcript analysis by its label alone.
- Event details identifies names, dates, program titles, schedules, and logistics. The label guides interpretation; it is not a separate event-data or fact-checking engine.
- Background and context informs planning but is blocked from soundbite searches. Use it for outlines, scripts, research, schedules, and material that must not be represented as interview speech.
- Quotes and testimonials identifies approved proof or a quote bank. Use Interview transcript instead when exact transcript provenance is required.
- Dates and fact checking identifies the reference StoryTable should consult for names, dates, figures, and specifications. It does not independently prove that every statement in the file is correct.
- Writing Style reference guides tone, cadence, structure, and technique. Its subjects and claims are not treated as story evidence.
- Primary source makes one document the lead source in ordinary planning. Choosing another Primary automatically demotes the previous one to Supporting.
- A transcript collection does not require a Primary source. You may mark every interview file Interview transcript so StoryTable considers them as peers.
- Excluded keeps the copied file attached but removes it from source context, transcript analysis, and quote search until it is assigned another purpose.

The Purpose menu is editable, but custom wording does not create a new processing rule. Use one of the built-in purposes for dependable inclusion and quotation behavior, then use How StoryTable should use it for the specific nuance. Changing a Purpose or its instructions affects the next outline, analysis, or AI writing action; it does not silently

rewrite work that was already saved.

Use the instruction column to describe evidence boundaries, not merely the desired prose. Useful examples include:

> *Treat this as current-year evidence. Do not reuse comments identified as last year.*

> *Quotes must be verbatim and attributed to the named speaker. Use the event description only as context, not as quotation text.*

> *This document is background only. Do not infer dates or identities that are not stated in a primary transcript.*

Transcribe a recording

Choose Transcribe Recording... in Source Documents and select a supported audio or video file. StoryTable prepares the audio, detects speakers, preserves timestamps, and writes a speaker-labeled SRT into the project. In interview projects, successive recordings remain Interview transcript peers instead of replacing one another as the primary source. Long recordings are divided into safe request-sized parts and reassembled into one continuous transcript.

After transcription, Name Speakers... lets you replace detected labels such as Speaker 1 with real names in the latest transcribed recording. StoryTable updates that recording's SRT, saved evidence and related quote components, without renaming a different interview that happens to use the same detected label. Review uncertain speaker turns before using them publicly.

Transcription is a hosted action. You must be signed in, and FFmpeg must be available in the packaged app or local installation. The original recording is retained as project evidence; the editable transcript is the SRT copy.

Choose Create Page Outline or Update Page Outline after the brief or supporting evidence changes. Review the resulting outline before generating images.

Complete interview analysis and progress

Interview Edit Script projects, sources marked Interview transcript, and timed transcript projects use a complete-source analysis stage before story assembly. Every included transcript is read in full and analyzed in bounded sections; long files are not reduced to an initial excerpt. StoryTable keeps each section's findings and exact quote candidates, then compares the evidence across interviews to build the plan.

StoryTable measures the extracted text and serialized request directly. A transcript stays in one analysis section when it fits the safe section budget; larger transcripts are divided without mixing their source identity. Every finished section is checkpointed. The final step reads the saved, source-organized catalog rather than resending completed transcript sections. If that catalog is too large for one planning context, StoryTable selects evidence through smaller, cached batches before assembling the final context.

Exact-quote checking is intentionally non-blocking at this preliminary stage. If AI proposes a candidate whose speaker, words, or time range cannot be verified against the transcript, StoryTable excludes that candidate, records the exclusion in the coverage files, and continues with the verified findings and soundbites. One optional bad quote must not abort the project outline.

The progress display names the source and shows completed/total sections and selection batches, elapsed time, and time since the last completion. Selection uses a fixed batch plan with bounded retries. Final story assembly shows 0 / 1 until the complete result is verified; it cannot report model-internal progress. Tasks without a known total explicitly say that the total is not yet known. You can pause or cancel. Completed analysis sections are saved for retry; a changed source, purpose or instruction is rechecked before cached work is used. Cancellation or an analysis failure preserves the existing plan and images. Unreadable, malformed or incomplete included sources are identified for

repair. Premiere transcript exports may contain a valid time range and speaker name with no dialogue. These empty blocks do not block analysis: their original text stays in the source coverage, but they are never offered as soundbites. The Editorial Desk also reuses this complete saved analysis when only its final set of story assignments needs to be regenerated.

In Files, look under Story Data for book/transcript-analysis/. The coverage report, complete catalog and planning context show which sources and sections were processed. Coverage confirms that the material was processed; review is still needed for the interpretation and editorial choices.

Source Images

Source Images are images StoryTable can read as evidence, not merely pictures to imitate.

1. Choose Add Images.
2. Select one or more PNG, JPEG, or WebP files.
3. Choose Analyze Selected Images or Analyze All Unread Images; each button shows its image count.
4. Review what StoryTable found.

Large readable source images are accepted and normalized to a bounded working copy inside the project; StoryTable retains the original filename and digest as provenance. In a multi-file selection, one unreadable image no longer cancels the valid imports. StoryTable adds every readable file and identifies any skipped filenames and reasons.

Choose Select All Images to select the complete source-image list. Choose Remove All Selected... to remove the selected unused images and their saved analysis in one confirmed operation. Removal is all-or-nothing: if any selected image is still assigned to an output page, no selected image is removed.

When choosing Add Existing Images for a page, the source-image picker shows Assigned to Page... or Not assigned to a page beneath every photo. Selecting an item displays a larger preview beside the list. Choose View Full Size..., double-click the list item, or double-click the larger preview for the full-size StoryTable viewer. Existing assignments do not prevent assigning one source image to another page.

The review area contains:

- Visible text
- Interpretation
- Suggested caption
- Key facts
- Uncertainties
- Page and caption instructions

Suggested caption is StoryTable's editable AI analysis; it is not the caption embedded in the original file. StoryTable separately reads supported embedded Description/caption/comment fields and Creator/artist fields from PNG, JPEG, and WebP metadata.

Each writing field can use Write with AI. Give a specific instruction such as:

> *Write a short past-tense caption using the event name, date, and listed activities. Describe what happened rather than inviting the reader to attend.*

StoryTable saves source-image review edits automatically after a short pause. Save Now is also available. A save failure keeps the edits visible and prevents navigation away until the problem is resolved.

The Page Images panel also has Analyze Selected Images and Analyze All beside the page-image list. These actions analyze the visible attachments in place and save the same transcription, interpretation, facts, caption, and uncertainty fields to their shared Source Images records. Analyze All asks before replacing analysis that has already been

reviewed.

For a multi-page photo sequence, select the source photos and choose Build Photo Story.... Photo density is the maximum number of selected photos that may appear on one page. When Target pages/cards is Auto and Use every selected image is checked, StoryTable expands an ordinary presentation or document to however many pages that density requires. A real publishing cap for one platform-native output, such as one social carousel, remains a hard limit; StoryTable identifies that exact limit instead of replacing it with a generic failure message.

Use Page Text source to decide what StoryTable places in the on-screen Page Text field for the proposed outline:

- AI-written from all reviewed evidence uses metadata, visible text,

reviewed visual analysis, source facts, and project direction.

- Embedded caption: verbatim copies the original file's

Description/caption/comment wording without an AI rewrite. On a grouped page, distinct captions appear in source-image order; repeats appear once.

- Embedded caption: adapt to Writing Style may reshape only the embedded

caption in the selected Writing Style. It cannot introduce facts. If an adaptation is unsupported, StoryTable keeps the embedded wording instead.

The two embedded-caption modes leave body Page Text blank when an assigned photo has no embedded caption; StoryTable does not substitute its Suggested caption. Enable Add photographer credit to on-screen Page Text to append Photo: Name or Photos: Name · Name from embedded Creator/artist metadata. Missing creator metadata adds no invented credit. These are Page Text controls: the project's Words inside images setting still determines whether Page Text is rendered visibly in the generated artwork.

If the project has source images but no transcript or source document, the main Build Project Outline action automatically follows this same photo-story route. The optional batch-instructions field may be blank. StoryTable uses the complete source-image collection, analyzes any unread files, and shows the proposed page groups before changing the outline; it does not demand a text source for an image-led slideshow.

Choose the creative effect

For the selected source image, use How should this image shape the story and artwork?

- Save for later - no creative effect yet stores the analysis without adding it to the brief, outline, or artwork.
- Inform the whole story - add its analysis to the Project Brief adds the reviewed meaning and facts to the story-wide brief.
- Make it its own page - write and illustrate a page from it creates one dedicated page using the reviewed copy and the original image as-is in a styled layout.
- Shape Page N only adds the reviewed context to one existing page and attaches the original for as-is use.

For as-is use, StoryTable may crop, mask, frame, and style around the supplied image, but it must not redraw or replace the people or content in that image. Use-as-is applies to the supplied photo, not to the surrounding page design: selected backgrounds, architectural references, paper textures, frames, typography, and brand colors still apply. Instructions assigning a reference as an accurate real space remain authoritative; StoryTable must not substitute an invented space. When all page and design references exceed the upload limit, StoryTable packs references into labeled sheets while retaining every source and its assigned role. Individual panels may be resized to fit these sheets.

In generated page artwork, frames belong only around actual foreground images when the selected style calls for frames. Each frame hugs its image's bounds and follows its aspect ratio. Backgrounds, unused layout slots, text, and logos do not receive photo frames. A style without frames does not acquire them. Separate frame PNGs remain available through Create Slide Assets for you to place manually.

For pages with assigned images and a resolved layout, StoryTable prepares the occupied image regions for generation. Unused photo slots and the raw layout guide are omitted from the AI request; the saved layout remains unchanged. Text, backgrounds, Brand elements, and negative space retain their roles. Freeform or ambiguous layouts keep their arrangement. When no foreground photos remain, samples saved solely to guide photo borders are omitted from the request. Paper, typography, and mixed-purpose references remain available for their other roles.

For imported PDF pages, StoryTable checks older extracted images that still carry the default photograph role, across all supplied-image treatments and text settings. Confirmed text-led graphics with no real photographic content are treated as source graphics rather than photographs and do not receive photo frames. With Recreate the same image in the selected style, an assigned title graphic remains required content: its message, hierarchy, and internal composition guide the new artwork. A style or background sample cannot replace that graphic with its own subject. As-is preserves the graphic when text is enabled; for text-free as-is artwork it becomes source content/design evidence. Inspiration permits reinterpretation. The current text-in-art setting controls lettering. Actual photos, photographed signs or artwork, graphics containing real photos, and uncertain cases keep their applicable treatment.

The initial reading may use AI; later runs can reuse its classification and wording while the file and analysis settings match. Source files and saved assignments remain unchanged. Review the generated result to confirm its composition and source fidelity. After updating StoryTable, regenerate affected artwork to use this preparation; existing images do not change automatically.

Turn several source images into pages

Use the batch source-image page action when each selected image should become its own page. Enter shared page and caption instructions before creating the pages.

The operation continues past images that cannot be applied. It reports and skips images that have not been analyzed or already have a dedicated source-image page instead of stopping the entire batch.

Project direction

Project direction includes:

- Project template
- Goal
- Deliverable
- Audience
- Channel or destination
- Writing Style
- Visual Style
- Brand
- Project size
- Landscape or Portrait orientation
- Words inside images
- Additional writing and image instructions

Library selections are captured into the project. Editing the original Library item later does not silently change an existing project's saved direction.

Plan begins with six broad Goals: repurpose existing material, teach or explain, guide a process, create information graphics, tell or recap a story, and promote or persuade. Select More Goals to expand specialized or custom Goal cards. The Presets area initially shows the three Presets that directly match the selected Goal; Browse All Presets... reveals the rest of the installed collection. Goals and Presets use visual cards that show the transformation or starting workflow at a glance.

Visual Styles are organized by category so you can narrow the card grid before choosing a look. Each card uses a short, readable summary for browsing. The complete saved Visual Style description and reference-image direction remain attached to the style and are still used when StoryTable creates artwork; the card summary does not shorten or replace those generation instructions.

Project Characters

Add recurring Characters from the Character Library. Character cards include thumbnails where available.

- Add to Project captures the selected Character in the current project.
- Update from Library refreshes that project's saved Character snapshot.
- Remove from Project removes it from this project's cast without deleting the Character from Libraries.

You can also add characters directly under the selected page's Characters section. Choose a character in its Library selector and click Add from Library, or choose Create Character... to save a new reusable character with its appearance and reference images. Either action adds the character to the project and assigns it to this page. Existing checked characters stay assigned; uncheck anyone who should not appear. Campaign draft updates preserve these explicit page selections, including an empty cast. Your selected cast takes precedence over the character in Library campaign artwork.

Typography

Set font family, typography rules, a typography reference image, and guidance. Typography is live project direction; it does not require text to be painted into generated artwork.

Font menus list the fonts installed on your computer, with a sample beside each name. Type part of a name to find a font. Choose Preview... to audition fonts with your own words, preview size, bold, and italic. Use Font applies the chosen family; Cancel leaves your saved choice unchanged. Preview size, bold, and italic are audition controls; set design instructions in Typography rules.

These controls are available in Plan, Create/Refine Art Direction, Brands, and Visual Styles, including alternative fonts. Clear the project font field to inherit the Brand or Visual Style's typography. Saved font names remain intact if a font is unavailable on another computer; the preview identifies the fallback it uses. To add fonts, install them in Windows or macOS and reopen StoryTable if needed. Direct font-file import into StoryTable is not available.

Layout Families and Current-Page AI Writing

In Customize Project Template, select several layout cards and drag them into Selected Layout Family. Use Ctrl or Shift to select several entries there, then drag them to change their order. Saving preserves that order. Layout filters include Story / Article, with editorial column and photo-feature examples. Preview diagrams use text lines and photo symbols inside the saved regions. Additional Writing Instructions and Additional Artwork Instructions add requirements to the selected reusable setup.

Browse All Presets... expands the installed choices in place. The expanded view remains open during refreshes for the same Goal; Show Recommended Presets returns to the shorter selection.

The Pages list and selected-page settings scroll independently. Keep the desired page visible in the list while moving its images. Upload New Page Images imports new files; Add Existing Images to Page selects project images and shows where they are already assigned. Delete Page is in the active-page actions; Delete Selected (x) Pages... acts on checked pages above the list.

Page Type, Content Type and Include Brand Logo appear below the page list. Write with AI beside Alt Text offers an accessibility-first description for review. Page-writing actions capture current editor values and current image assignments at submission. Saved image analysis provides visual evidence; unanalyzed images are treated as unknown. Review the suggestion before accepting it, especially when describing artwork that has not yet been

generated.

Page Outline

The Page Outline controls the ordered pages. The left side lists Pages and supports drag ordering. Right-click a page to save, analyze, rebuild, create artwork, duplicate, reorder, or delete it.

Available actions include:

- Add Page
- Duplicate Page
- Delete Page
- Import PDF as Pages
- Create or Update Page Outline
- Save Page
- Save Project Plan

Choose Duplicate Page beside Add Page to copy the selected page directly after it. StoryTable saves pending page edits first, then copies the page text, settings, layout, reference assignments, transcript evidence, current artwork, and complete image revision history. The copy has its own editable page and artwork history, so later changes do not overwrite the original. Duplication uses no AI generation and starts the new page unlocked.

For the selected page, review or edit:

- Page Text and Caption, grouped in Page Content
- Page Images and Characters, grouped in Page Content
- Verified transcript evidence, speaker name, transcript filename, and time range for every soundbite or splice component
- Page Art Direction, including Layout and placement direction
- Page Type and Content Type
- Alt Text and the Include Brand Logo choice
- Deliverable-specific details, such as lyric, motion, or event-poster fields

Use Write Caption with AI to draft a caption and Copy to copy it. Publication captions autosave after a short pause.

Choose the writer and keep that voice with the project

Writing Voice is visible during setup for the Editorial Desk, Evergreen Content Finder, and Instagram Strategy Desk, and in each desk above its instructions. Choose your saved brand voice there. Every project created from that desk inherits the choice and its complete saved instructions, including point of view. Opportunity recommendations cannot replace your chosen writer.

In an article or other authored project, Writing Voice also appears above the outline in Plan and above the page controls in Create & Refine, including Simple View. This selects the writer for the current output and saves automatically. It controls perspective, emphasis, tone, pacing, and focus while the supplied sources remain the factual evidence. Saving, reopening, and creating another output retain the profile; you can give another output a different writer.

Changing the voice keeps existing copy available and shows how many pages need rewriting. In Plan > Page Content, use Regenerate Text to review new copy in the selected voice. Creating or regenerating an image does not rewrite the article. A saved project retains its voice even if that Library entry later becomes unavailable. If both the saved profile and Library entry are missing, StoryTable asks you to select a voice instead of substituting a default writer.

Page Text and image-only PDF wording

An imported label such as "Page 3 from source PDF." is not presentation copy. New PDF pages without a readable text layer leave Page Text empty until source wording is available. For older imported placeholders, generation uses extracted text blocks first, then reads the visible headline and body wording from the current assigned page images when needed. It preserves the source language and wording rather than inventing a generic title. The complete PDF page is a fallback only when no page images are assigned. Recovered wording is saved into editable Page Text during image-generation preparation so you can review and revise the actual words. This happens only while the saved field is an unextracted blank or the exact importer placeholder; newer edits and changed image assignments are checked before saving. Repeated generation can reuse the source reading, and user-written Page Text takes precedence.

To remove page copy, clear Page Text and save. A deliberately cleared field stays empty after saving and reopening; StoryTable does not refill it from old copy or source analysis. Typing new words replaces that choice. Leaving a newly imported empty field untouched still allows missing source wording to be read. Text in Generated Artwork separately controls whether lettering is included in generated pixels. Review any words already embedded in a supplied as-is image under that setting.

Replace a quote without losing transcript grounding

For pages built around an interview quotation, Find Another Soundbite... is located directly with Page Text. It is different from Regenerate Text:

- Find Another Soundbite... searches every quote-eligible transcript, excludes the current quote and soundbites already used elsewhere, and returns only a candidate that StoryTable can verify locally against the source words.
- Regenerate Text writes new page copy in the selected Writing Style. It is not the correct action when the result must remain a verbatim quotation.

Describe the editorial job of the replacement, including exclusions. For example:

> *Find a current-year student quote about feeling welcomed. Do not use this speaker, last-year references, or a paraphrase. Prefer a specific lived moment over a general claim.*

The review dialog shows the proposed exact words, speaker name, transcript filename, in/out time, and whether the result is one continuous excerpt or an explicitly marked same-speaker splice. Each splice component has its own speaker and transcript attribution. Plan, Create, Refine and edit-script views also display this attribution; unavailable metadata is labeled Unknown speaker or Unknown transcript instead of being guessed. Nothing changes until you accept it. If no eligible exact match exists, StoryTable should report that it found none rather than inventing one.

The Transcript Evidence section appears when the project includes a transcript and stores the editable evidence record. Keep Page Text, Caption, and exact transcript evidence in their separate fields. For an ordinary transcript-based story, transcript evidence is supporting provenance rather than the output itself. If one proposed excerpt cannot be verified word for word, StoryTable omits only that excerpt and continues saving the completed output plan. A page with no remaining verified excerpt keeps its Page Text and publication caption and leaves the evidence field empty. An Interview Edit Script remains stricter because its exact soundbites are the deliverable.

Supplied images on a page

Each page can have supplied photographs or reference images. Choose the treatment deliberately:

- Use supplied image faithfully in one AI-designed composition
- Recreate the same image in the selected style

- Use as inspiration for new artwork in the selected style

This distinction is preserved when images are generated. As-is sends the original sources and applicable content/background references to the image provider for one unified composition. Visual Style examples marked Style Only contribute their saved design descriptions and directions, without uploading their image files. StoryTable instructs the provider to include the supplied asset once without redrawing, duplicating, or replacing it; it does not create a local backing plate or paste the source on afterward. It requests the provider's high input-fidelity mode for this treatment. Use it for photographs, screenshots, documents, readable signs, diagrams, exact likeness, or any source whose visible content must remain intact, and review the provider result for fidelity. Recreate sends the source to the image model and preserves its subjects, setting, composition, viewpoint, and important details while rendering a new image in the selected style. Inspiration permits a new composition and may change or omit people, objects, wording, setting, and viewpoint. Existing project data that formerly used faithful redraw opens as Recreate the same image in the selected style rather than silently changing to inspiration.

What saves automatically in Plan

The following use a short delayed autosave:

- Source-image review fields and per-image instructions
- Captions
- Page Layout selection and layout direction

Other page fields use Save Page. Story-wide Plan changes use Save Project Plan or the header Save.

Create a Schedule

Choose Create a Schedule as the Goal. The Schedule Layout and Venue Colors panel appears beside the Project Brief and is also available during setup.

Choose Event cards with automatic density or 2, 4, 6, or 8 cards per page. Choose Timetable to put times down the left, earliest first, with simultaneous events aligned horizontally. Its headers can be day/date columns with one venue per page, or venue columns with one day/date per page. Enter day/date headings or venue names in the adjacent boxes; blank headings are taken from the source. Edit an individual page heading under Page Content.

Venue colors come from the selected Color Scheme, or from the Brand when no scheme overrides it. The first venues use the palette in order. Additional venues receive coordinated shades chosen to stay visually separated. Adding a venue preserves existing assignments; changing the palette recolors the whole schedule together. Events retain venue names and a color legend, so readers do not have to identify a venue by color alone.

Set grouping before building the outline. If you change grouping later, rebuild the outline to redistribute events across pages. Regenerate existing artwork to show changed layouts or colors. Saved Presets and project outputs retain these settings, and exports include the schedule details and venue color assignments.

7. Create

When a project has multiple outputs, Create Artwork for All Outputs appears. It quotes the combined image scope before submission, completes one named output at a time, and then returns to the output you were editing. The ordinary Missing, Selected, and All actions remain scoped to the current output.

Create submits page-writing, image-generation, and reusable-design-asset work.

Edit Selected Area

In Create & Refine, select a page with an accepted image and choose Edit Selected Area... beneath the image. Unlock the page first if necessary. This works on images with or without page text.

1. Draw a rectangle around the object or detail you want to change. Leave room around it for a natural result. The shaded area outside the rectangle is protected.
2. Describe the change: for example, "remove the cup and restore the tabletop," "change the jacket to blue," or "replace this background detail with flowers."
3. Adjust Edge blending if needed. It softens the transition inside the selection; Sharp edges applies the result up to the rectangle boundary. Draw again or choose Clear Selection to change the area.
4. Choose Review Cost and Edit... and review the estimate for one AI image edit.
5. Review the new version using Compare. Use Restore Selected in Version History to return to the earlier image.

StoryTable sends the accepted image and a marked selection guide. Only pixels inside the selected rectangle are taken from the AI result; every pixel outside is retained from the accepted image. Edge blending also stays inside the rectangle. The edit uses the instructions entered in this dialog. Other pending page wording, style and whole-image revision instructions are not applied by this action. Canceled or failed edits retain the accepted image. AI results within the selection should be reviewed for appearance and accuracy. For an exact installed font, use Apply Font to Selected Paragraph... instead.

Regenerate All Page Text (AI)

Open Create & Refine, select a page, edit Page Text to contain the complete replacement wording, and choose Regenerate All Page Text (AI) beside the text editor. Review the estimate for one AI image edit before continuing. The page must have an accepted image containing text and must be unlocked.

StoryTable sends the accepted page image as the sole visual reference. The image model replaces its presentation wording while being instructed to preserve the artwork, composition, colors and text placement. Typography keeps its existing appearance except for explicit character settings you choose. The model approximates font choices; use Apply Font to Selected Paragraph for an exact installed font. General Image Revision notes are not applied by this action. Small line-wrap or type-size adjustments may be needed to fit the replacement copy.

The result is saved as a new image version. Use Compare to check the wording and design, or Restore Selected to return to the earlier image. AI edits can introduce visual differences; this operation does not guarantee identical pixels outside the lettering. Failed or canceled revisions keep the previous image.

Generation actions

- Generate Pages and Images creates the page plan and image work in one guided operation.
- Generate Page Text generates or updates page text without generating all images.
- Create Missing Images generates only pages that currently need an image.
- Create Selected Images uses the checked pages.
- Create All Images submits all eligible pages.
- Generate Asset Collection creates a new reusable design system for the current presentation canvas, using the project style or another installed Visual Style.
- Create Social Assets creates platform-ready reusable design elements for selected social formats.

Before image work, StoryTable shows the scope, actionable page count, cost estimate, and notes. Review this preflight before continuing.

Image estimates separate one attempt per actionable image from the maximum allowance if every permitted retry is needed. The retry allowance is a ceiling, not the expected bill. Reused source readings and prompt preparation may avoid repeat work; the final usage depends on the work actually performed.

Page selection and status

The page list shows the status of every page. Checkboxes define Create Selected Images.

The selected-page action uses status-consistent wording:

- Create Image when no current image exists.
- Recreate Image when the current image needs regeneration.

Locked pages are always skipped by generation actions.

Skip, include, and remove

- Skip Image excludes the page from Create Missing, Selected, and All.
- Include Image makes a skipped page eligible again.
- Remove Current Image removes the active image while retaining prior revisions for possible restoration.
- Remove Legacy Text Overlay removes an old live-text overlay without using AI.

Image work can finish with a mix of successful, skipped, and failed pages. Review each page status rather than assuming a 100% operation bar means every page produced a new image.

Generate an asset collection

The entry button establishes the workflow, so the dialog does not ask you to choose Slide versus Social a second time.

For both workflows, choose Visual style first:

- Use project style uses the visual-style snapshot saved with the project and may use representative current accepted artwork as visual evidence.
- Choosing an installed Visual Style makes that style authoritative for this asset request. StoryTable keeps the current project brand, typography, content, and compatible guidance, but excludes accepted artwork and project visual references made under the prior style.

Generate Asset Collection uses the current project's slide canvas. Choose the reusable asset role and quantity, then optionally provide overall and per-variation design direction. This is the broad asset-authoring workflow: it can follow the project style or deliberately use another installed Visual Style. To package assets that already belong to the open project, use Export Project Assets in Export instead.

The slide kit separates the background surface from the pieces you arrange on top:

- 01_backgrounds contains fully opaque PNG backgrounds at the active project canvas size. The default landscape canvas is 3840 x 2160 pixels; a portrait project keeps its portrait canvas. The background carries the selected visual medium and substrate. For a charcoal-on-paper style, charcoal drawing and paper are the foundation. Frames, callout panels, decorative flourishes, and complete slide layouts belong in other files.
- 02_frames contains separate landscape, portrait, and square PNG frames. Both the area outside each frame and its empty image opening are transparent. Place your own image behind the frame so it remains visible through the opening.
- 03_text_backings contains title, caption, lower-third, and body-copy surfaces. The surface behind your text is opaque, with transparency around its designed edges. Add your own editable text on top.
- 04_callouts contains reusable panels, labels, badges, and annotation pieces. Text-bearing panels have opaque interiors and transparent surroundings; arrows and pointers retain transparency wherever nothing is drawn.
- 05_graphics_and_accents contains separate symbols, strokes, rules, flourishes, and other decorative PNGs with transparent backgrounds.

Before generation, preflight lists the asset types that will be created and the standard types that are absent from the request. StoryTable creates a category folder only when that category has an exported asset or sidecar file. An absent

category, or a category whose generation fails without producing a usable file, does not leave an empty folder in the asset export.

Use these files to arrange your own templates and presets in Google Slides, Canva, PowerPoint, or another design tool. The selected style determines their shared drawing, material, and color treatment; it does not combine them into one fixed composition.

When a completed opaque background and usable pieces are available, 06_examples includes flattened composition guides made from those exact exported PNGs. The examples introduce no extra generated imagery, text, or sample photos and require no additional AI generation charge. Frame openings show the actual background underneath. You can follow a guide or arrange every piece differently. Each guide has a companion layout file recording its source files and placements. A guide demonstrates available pieces; it does not mean every requested asset succeeded.

Create Social Assets uses a platform-oriented Asset kit, such as Instagram, Facebook, YouTube, LinkedIn, TikTok, X, Pinterest, or Cross-platform essentials. The selected platform reveals its applicable formats and exact dimensions. Choose:

- the platform kit;
- one or more included formats;
- the specific reusable Asset role;
- variations per format; and
- optional overall or per-variation design direction.

The summary shows the exact file multiplier before the cost preflight. Each format is designed independently for its target canvas and safe-area guidance. StoryTable does not crop one master design into every ratio. The generated manifest records the platform, placement, dimensions, selected style, safe-zone guidance, and specification sources.

8. Create & Refine

Create & Refine is one screen for page-by-page creation, text editing, image assignment, review and revision. Choose a page in the navigator; its artwork, editable Page Text and source images are available immediately. There is no separate review screen to open.

Regenerate All Page Text (AI) sits with Page Text. Create Image or Regenerate Image sits under the artwork. Expand Image Changes to give instructions for a full image revision, or Version History to compare and restore earlier artwork. Art Direction, colors, Brand and layout controls follow the text and image controls. Batch creation actions sit below the workspace. At smaller window widths, the panels stack so the controls remain reachable.

Headings, body copy and character settings

Select text in Page Text and use Paragraph to mark the selected paragraphs as Heading, Subheading or Body. The editor displays the hierarchy without showing the saved structural tags. Each page has independent Heading, Subheading and Body styles; select the style under Text style to change its installed font family, face and size. All text (base) supplies shared choices; each role overrides only the properties you set for it.

Expand Spacing and Font Preview to set line spacing and letter spacing and see each paragraph in its own style. Changing Heading settings affects only Heading paragraphs in this preview; Body and Subheading retain their settings. The line below Text style identifies how many paragraphs use the style you are editing. Switching this menu chooses which style to edit; it does not assign that style to text. Use Paragraph above the text editor to assign a style. The Page Text editor shows the paragraph hierarchy; the font preview shows your font choices. Keep Current Lettering clears the selected style's overrides. These controls save automatically; the artwork changes only when you apply an edit or regenerate.

To apply the actual installed font to one paragraph:

1. Click inside that paragraph in Page Text, or highlight the paragraphs you want.
2. Choose the font family and face in the character controls.
3. Choose Apply Font to Selected Paragraph....
4. Drag a rectangle tightly around the old lettering on the artwork. Leave room

for the replacement, but exclude other paragraphs. Only this rectangle can change.

5. Review the actual font preview. Set the text color, alignment and size;

Fit to area sizes it automatically. The dialog shows artwork pixels, converting an explicit point size using the image resolution.

6. Choose Review Cost and Apply..., then review the estimate for one image edit.

StoryTable asks AI to restore the background behind the old lettering, then places the locally rendered font in the selected rectangle. Every pixel outside the rectangle is copied from the accepted image unchanged. Check the background cleanup in the new version; the white preview backing is only a font and placement preview. The original remains in Version History. Other pending wording changes are not applied by this action. Unavailable fonts, faces or characters are reported before submitting an image request.

Regenerate All Page Text (AI) redraws the page's complete wording, approximates fonts, and may change other areas. Use it for a whole-page wording revision.

At the top of Art Direction, Text in Artwork offers three explicit project-level choices: Automatic: decide per page, Include Page Text in artwork, and Keep Page Text outside artwork. The explanatory line beneath the control shows the selected page's resolved behavior in Automatic mode. Changing this setting does not delete Page Text or Caption copy.

Edit text and captions

- Edit Page Text; it saves automatically. Save Now saves immediately.
- Edit the publication caption; it autosaves after a short pause.
- Use Write Caption with AI for a reviewed suggestion.
- Use Copy to place the active caption on the clipboard.

Revise an image

1. Select the page.
2. Enter revision notes.
3. Choose Regenerate Image.
4. Review the resulting current version and status.

StoryTable creates a new revision rather than overwriting the prior generated version.

Version history

The Version history panel supports:

- Compare
- Restore Selected

Restoring a version makes it current without destroying the other recorded revisions.

Lock an accepted image

Lock an image when it must not be regenerated or replaced. A lock protects that page from:

- Regeneration

- Replacement
- Removal of the current image
- Bulk image generation

Unlock the image explicitly before changing it.

Skip or remove

Skip Image temporarily excludes the page from image batches. Remove Current Image removes only the active image reference; retained revisions remain available in history.

9. Publish

Export begins with a centered Project Preview and an Export Tools card grid. Choose Export Project, Finish in Claude Design, Caption, Export Project Assets, Export History, or Batch Projects to open that tool in the central settings area. For a multi-output project, the primary action becomes Export All Outputs. StoryTable creates one package per target plus a master folder and ZIP. The scope determines whether to use only completed images or retained saved versions. Missing or unverified files cannot be exported. Ordinary publication packaging does not generate artwork. Claude Design handoff and matching project-asset creation are separate, explicit choices with generation estimates before any required image work.

Finish in Claude Design packages page artwork and raster source/reference images as WebP copies at the same displayed pixel dimensions, preserving transparency. It uses high-quality compression, or lossless WebP when smaller; existing WebP files are copied without recompression. The original PNGs and other project images stay unchanged. Documents and vector artwork retain their formats. The completion dialog reports the whole ZIP size and flags packages over 20 MB; WebP compression alone does not guarantee that every package fits.

Publish creates a verified, shareable package from current page images and captions.

For an Editorial Text Document, Publish hides the image preview, Caption, Claude Design, and project-asset tools. Export Scope becomes document sections, and Export Text Document writes editable Markdown and plain text rather than an image publication package.

Choose the scope

- All completed page images includes pages whose images match their saved generation state.
- Current page only uses the selected completed page.
- Selected page numbers uses the entered page range under the normal completion checks.
- All saved page images includes every retained accepted image on disk, even when the page says Needs Image Regeneration or a later attempt failed.

Choose All saved page images to export the finished versions already in your project without regenerating them. Review identifies saved images that may not reflect the latest settings. Missing, uncommitted or changed image files still fail verification. This scope works for publication packages, Claude Design handoffs and multi-output packages; it does not change page status, locks or image history.

Choose caption behavior

For every Instagram channel project, captions have a 2,200-character maximum, including spaces, punctuation, hashtags and mentions. A live 0/2200 counter above the caption editor updates as you type; its tooltip explains the limit. When captions are written for individual carousel slides, their combined text shares this ceiling, including the blank lines between captions. The page editor and publishing screen show that combined total too.

Write with AI writes the shortest caption that communicates the post's intent, adds useful context, and includes an

appropriate call to action. It avoids repeating slide content or adding filler to approach the maximum. StoryTable counts the finished text in code and automatically revises an over-limit result before review. You can still save a handwritten draft while editing, but an over-limit draft cannot be accepted as an AI suggestion, copied as a publishing caption, or exported. Use Export Project > Publishing Caption > Write Captions with AI to revise a full set of existing slide captions together, or choose one whole-post caption. Slide text, quotations in the artwork, and images are not rewritten by caption revision.

- A different caption for each page offers Write Captions with AI and shows how many pages already have captions. Review the drafts together, edit them, and uncheck any you want to leave unchanged before choosing Use Captions. Review Page Captions opens the page-level editor.
- One caption for the complete post or sequence provides one shared Caption field for the active output.

Choose Caption format first. Write Caption with AI immediately drafts one caption from the complete active output. Write Captions with AI drafts a separate caption for each page, with the surrounding sequence as context. You do not need to supply another prompt: StoryTable uses the Project Brief, page content, audience, channel, caption voice (or project writing voice), source evidence and campaign settings. In the single-caption review, use Refine Again with optional feedback to revise the draft. The page-level Write with AI buttons work the same way. Saved copy changes only when you accept the suggestion.

Captions are optional: leaving the selected caption fields blank exports the artwork and other available handoff files without a captions.txt file.

Review before export

Set:

- Destination folder
- Optional package name
- Export scope
- Caption mode

Review the package preview and scope. Use All saved page images when you want retained accepted versions despite newer settings or a failed later attempt. Relink missing images and resolve version or file-verification errors before exporting.

Publication package contents

Export Publication Package creates both a folder and ZIP containing:

- <project-name>-publication.pdf - ordered visual review with selectable caption text, using the same project-name prefix as the HTML and PowerPoint exports
- images/ - numbered full-resolution current images in publication order
- captions.txt - one text file for the active caption setup
- publish.csv - image order, captions, destination, and size data
- manifest.json - package metadata and file checksums
- README.txt - handoff instructions
- an offline HTML preview for browsing the package locally when included by the current export service

The PDF is a convenient review and copy/paste handoff. The separate files in images/ are the publication-ready originals. The offline HTML preview is a local package file that travels with its companion files; it is not automatically hosted on the web. Packaging copies current images without resizing or reformatting them and does not change the project.

Export history appears on the Publish screen.

Export Project Assets

Open Export Project Assets to see the separate reusable PNG components that currently belong to the open project's visual contract. Backgrounds, frames, text panels, callouts, and accents each appear as a visual inventory card with a real thumbnail and count when available. Existing assets are included automatically.

Use Add matching on an asset card when you need more of that type. New variations remain locked to the project's saved Visual Style, Brand, typography, visual references, and representative accepted artwork, so there is no second style selector or general design brief to manage in Export. StoryTable shows the number of existing and newly requested PNGs before you continue. AI preflight and cost approval appear only when you request new assets.

The export creates a folder and ZIP with a manifest and README. It creates only the category folders that contain real files; empty asset types are reported and skipped. Elements baked into a finished page image cannot be recovered as separate layers. Use Generate Asset Collection in Create when you want to invent a broader collection from a chosen Visual Style rather than package the open project's assets. StoryTable no longer offers a separate Canva Design Kit export of flattened page images.

Finish in Claude Design

Use Export for Claude Design when StoryTable should create all page imagery and Claude Design should finish the layout with live, editable text. Choose the scope and destination, export the ZIP, and then choose Import or Upload in Claude Design. Select the complete ZIP. This workflow does not require MCP, Claude Code, or a local connection between StoryTable and Claude Desktop.

Every exported page image is text-free. If a selected StoryTable image already contains presentation lettering, StoryTable offers to create a separate text-free export copy. Review the image count and estimated cost before that work begins. The copy is stored outside the accepted page revision and reused while its source image remains current. The finished page, lock state, settings and image history do not change.

The folder and ZIP contain:

- 01 TEXT-FREE ARTWORK/ with the completed StoryTable-created imagery
- 02 EDITABLE TEXT AND PAGE PLAN/page_plan.md with exact live copy and each page's saved typography and placement direction
- project_and_brand_context.md with the brief, audience, output goal, Library context, Brand rules and Visual Style snapshot
- 03 ORIGINAL SOURCES/ with the project-local source files
- 04 BRAND AND VISUAL REFERENCES/ with the project-local reference stack
- 00 PASTE INTO CLAUDE DESIGN.txt with the governing assembly request
- manifest.json with file hashes, page lineage and the text-free handoff contract

If Claude Design does not begin from the package automatically, open 00 START HERE - CLAUDE DESIGN.md and follow its short instructions, then paste 00 PASTE INTO CLAUDE DESIGN.txt. The request tells Claude Design to keep the StoryTable imagery intact, add exact_live_text as live text, translate saved hierarchy markers into text styles, and follow the page-level layout and typography directions. Review the first draft against page_plan.md before making local edits in Claude Design.

10. Files

Files is a read-only inventory of files stored with the current project. It does not move project files into a shared Library.

Actions

- Refresh

- Open File
- Show in Folder
- Open Project Folder

Reusable-asset creation lives on Create, alongside the other AI creation actions. Generated asset files remain inside the current project and appear in this Files inventory.

Filter and inspect

Filter by type or search by name. The table shows:

- File
- Type
- Size
- Page
- Location

File categories include generated pages and data, page and project references, source documents, source images, exports, StoryTable data, prompts, logs, and other project assets.

Select an image file to preview it. Double-click a file to open it with the operating system's associated application.

11. Libraries

Libraries is the reusable-asset workspace. It replaces the disconnected Classic UI library tabs with one type-aware screen.

Asset types

StoryTable has ten reusable Library types:

1. Template
2. Goal
3. Instruction Assistant
4. Deliverable
5. Channel
6. Writing Style
7. Brand
8. Visual Style
9. Layout
10. Character

Understand the Type menu and left navigation

The Type menu controls both the main stage and the left navigation.

All Types

When All Types is selected:

- The left navigation lists asset types with counts.
- The main stage groups cards by asset type.
- Selecting a type on the left opens that type and its applicable filters.

- New Asset asks which asset type to create.

One selected type

When a specific type is selected, the left navigation changes to:

- All items of that type
- StoryTable
- My Library
- Removed
- Folders
- Unfiled
- User-created folders for that type

The filters apply only to the selected asset type. A Visual Style folder, for example, is not shown as a Character filter.

Use Search to narrow the currently filtered results.

Consistent asset controls

The top action row provides:

- New Type
- Edit or Customize
- Duplicate
- Remove
- Restore
- Move to Folder
- Use in Project

Templates use Start New Project instead of Use in Project.

The Transfer row provides:

- Import Type
- Export Selected Type
- Export Library
- Import Library

Every reusable type can be transferred: Template, Goal, Instruction Assistant, Deliverable, Channel, Writing Style, Brand, Visual Style, Layout, and Character. StoryTable-supplied items can also be exported; an included Template is imported as an editable custom copy instead of replacing the included original.

StoryTable-supplied read-only items use Customize to create an editable user version. Remove is reversible; use the Removed filter and Restore to recover the item.

Six-Slide Pitch

Use Six-Slide Pitch to introduce any product or service to a specific client. It uses Promote or Persuade and creates one presentation with exactly six slides and a complete spoken pitch in the speaker notes.

1. Start a new project from Six-Slide Pitch.
2. In Six-slide pitch, enter the Client type, Product information,

and Customer outcome. Describe the customer starting point and why the result matters. Product information can include your product name, supported capabilities, facts, and proof; attach supporting sources when useful.

3. Choose Pitch delivery format: presentation slides, PowerPoint, or PDF.

This choice shapes the writing for presenting or reading. The customer outcome is the result you are selling, such as a schedule ready to send; delivery format is how you will share this pitch.

4. Shape Your pitch and Call to action. Request exact wording explicitly

where needed. These fields remain editable in Plan.

5. Generate and review the outline, slide text, speaker notes, and images. The

story moves from the client's situation and starting point to the product, a concrete example, a credible benefit, and a next step.

6. In Publish, choose the matching PowerPoint or PDF export when ready.

Choosing a delivery format in setup does not export a file automatically.

Each descriptive pitch field has Write with AI, including Why it matters, Your pitch, and the client and product fields. You can leave a field blank: the writer uses your other pitch entries and project context to suggest wording. Give optional direction, review or refine the suggestion, and choose Use Suggestion to apply it. Keep Current leaves your text unchanged.

Use Save as Template to reuse a pitch setup for a client segment. Adjust the client, product, outcome, and angle for the next pitch. The preset supports any product; StoryTable appears in the sales story only when you choose to pitch it.

Use separate Libraries

The Active Library menu in the upper-left sidebar switches between isolated reusable collections, such as Personal and Work. Open Library and choose New Library to create an empty collection. Switching Libraries changes the reusable items offered by StoryTable; it does not move or rewrite projects. Open projects retain their saved configuration and project-owned reference snapshots.

Library-backed selectors throughout StoryTable read from the active Library catalog across project creation, Plan, Settings, and reusable-item tools. Color Scheme entries show their five-swatch palette in menus and closed selectors; From Brand and Library-thumbnail choices show their effective palettes. Saved categories are disabled headings, including empty categories. Removed items stay hidden, while unavailable project choices remain representable.

When importing a .storytable-library file, StoryTable asks whether to:

- Merge into the active Library, adding the imported items to the current

collection and then resolving any matching-item conflicts; or

- Add as Separate Library, preserving the collection independently and

switching to it after import.

Export Library exports only the currently active Library.

Learn a person or organization's voice

Open Library Context from the Library screen. Enter the person's or organization's name, then choose A person (I / me / my) or An organization (we / us / our) under Writing voice.

1. Choose Learn Voice from Writing.
2. Paste their writing, add sample files, or enter published article URLs.
3. Choose Learn Voice to analyze their word choices, tone, rhythm, and

recurring habits. Review and edit the proposed voice traits below the samples.

4. Choose Use This Voice, then Save in Library Context.

With Use this voice for first-person writing enabled, first-person Writing Styles use this learned identity while keeping their purpose, structure, and channel requirements. Third-person writing keeps its selected voice. Samples guide the writing style; they do not supply facts for future projects.

The learned profile travels with the Library and is included in new projects' saved context. To update an existing project, select Apply these changes to every output in the currently open project when saving Library Context. Existing text stays unchanged until you rewrite it. Review or Learn Voice lets you edit the profile or learn from more samples. Uncheck the voice option to pause its use without deleting it, or choose Remove Voice.

Write an Analysis Preset

In Library Context, add or edit an Analysis Preset to describe what StoryTable should look for and how it should rank opportunities. The live count beneath the field shows how much you have written. Instructions and Library Context have no application-imposed character cap and are saved in full.

Write with AI uses advisory length targets to encourage concise, complete writing. Longer suggestions remain available to review, refine, and apply. Provider request limits and publishing-platform requirements still apply when performing those operations; they do not limit saving your instructions.

Share one item or a whole Library

Use Export Selected Type when you want to share one reusable item. The portable file contains that item and its owned local assets, such as Brand logos and imagery, Visual Style references, Layout composition references, Character references, writing samples, previews, or thumbnails. References are copied into the portable bundle; the receiving machine does not need the sender's original file paths. Per-item files intentionally do not carry the sender's folder placement or removed/restored state.

Use Export Library when you want a portable backup or transfer of the whole reusable workspace. A whole-Library file preserves reusable items, folders, folder assignments, removed/restored state, thumbnails, owned assets, and safe creative defaults. In other words, Export Library is the portable export for Library styles *and all reference material owned by those styles*. It does not contain projects, generated work, passwords, login sessions, API credentials, billing records, usage records, or logs.

When an import finds an item with the same identity, StoryTable asks whether to keep both versions, replace the matching item, or cancel/skip the conflict.

Typical file types are:

- .storytable-library for the complete reusable Library
- .storytable-template for a Template and its reusable dependencies
- .storytable-style for a Visual Style and its owned visual assets
- .storytable-asset for the other reusable item types

From All Types, StoryTable reads a .storytable-asset file and selects its declared asset type automatically. Template and Visual Style files keep their dedicated formats for compatibility.

Manage folders

Choose one asset type, then use:

- New Folder
- Rename Folder
- Delete Folder
- Move to Folder

Folders belong to the selected asset type. Deleting a folder does not delete its assets; its items become unfiled.

Thumbnails and previews

Every Library card has either an asset thumbnail or a deterministic fallback.

- Templates use their portable preview or a layout fallback.
- Brands use a logo, imagery, or palette-based preview.
- Visual Styles use their canonical preview or a fallback. Custom generation

sends actual style references with saved directions; to preserve an existing thumbnail's subject, select its reference option or write "current thumbnail."

- Layouts use the first attached composition reference or a schematic fallback.
- Characters use their saved preview, a reference image, or a fallback.
- Text-led types use type-appropriate deterministic cards.

Missing or unreadable thumbnail sources do not make assets disappear; StoryTable uses a fallback and keeps the item manageable.

Global reference-image contract

Version 0.1.281 rebuilds image requests from current settings and tracks which settings produced saved page directions. When settings change, superseded directions are removed from the request copy; editable originals remain available. Current source-image records replace older copied analysis blocks. Reference-plan caches include the page wording, visual direction, layout, and reference treatment. The prompt audit records input cleanup as well as prompt shortening.

StoryTable reuses verified factual image readings across pages when the actual source file, reading instructions, treatment, metadata, and analysis settings still match. It builds the current page wording, layout, style, and palette around those facts each time. A duplicated page can reuse the same verified readings. Older saved analyses without verification may need one fresh reading before reuse; missing or changed source files cannot use stale evidence.

Already-current directions and clearly factual notes avoid unnecessary AI cleanup. Ambiguous older design instructions can still use semantic cleanup. Validated prompt compression can be reused during the current app session when the complete prompt, protected copy and references, capacity, and rewriting settings match. Changed inputs are checked again. Exact page copy and reference assignments remain protected, and editable originals remain available.

Selected layout previews show the saved active-format regions. When source occupancy can be resolved, generation omits unused photo slots and raw layout guides while preserving the other regions. PDF import without a selected layout shows a flexible arrangement rather than implying fixed image/text positions. Choosing a preset replaces the prior layout direction. Its coordinates survive prompt shortening, and RTL text changes reading direction within its text region without mirroring the page layout.

StoryTable fits the complete request after its image attachments are resolved. It removes repeated wording, compacts prose, and can omit explicitly optional decoration. Version 0.1.362 protects literal page copy and source assignments and requires a separate meaning-preservation review before accepting AI compression. Unknown instructions are treated as required. Original and sent page prompts are saved under the project's prompt_audits folder, with preparation decisions. If required instructions still cannot fit below 32,000 characters, StoryTable explains the capacity problem before image submission; it does not silently discard those requirements. Simplify the named sections or split the design. Saving an applied Visual Style or explicitly applying the same style refreshes that project's snapshot. Other projects keep their existing snapshots. When adding several images, all newly added images remain selected; analysis and reference-behavior changes apply to that selection. Findings accumulate by image, and the combined visual direction reaches generation.

Version 0.1.276 defines each Visual Style reference behavior once per page request and maps each reference to that shared definition. Complete behavior rules and individual saved directions are retained. This reduces repeated

instructions; generated fidelity still requires visual review.

Version 0.1.275 applies one reference-handling contract to page artwork, Visual Style previews, Library thumbnails, Character previews and model sheets, Layout analysis, and reusable slide, social, and reel assets:

- StoryTable pairs uploaded references with their saved role and per-image directions. For as-is pages, Style Only examples contribute saved design guidance; their image files are excluded from the generation upload.
- Every Visual Style reference has one explicit behavior: Style Only, Faithful Reference Image, Background Photo (stylize only), Use As-Is, or Creative Inspiration. Choose it in the Visual Style editor for each selected reference.
- Faithful Reference Image applies the selected medium to the supplied subject, preserving identity, geometry, people, proportions and spatial relationships. Supplied references are used by default; replace one only when a specific page requirement clearly favors another supplied image. Never invent a substitute.
- Background Photo (stylize only) supplies the actual photo to treat as the page background. StoryTable selects 1 photo per page in a stable rotation, places it after assigned page photos in the image inputs, and retains the other saved design/frame directions. Naming a background photo's filename in Artwork Direction selects that photo. The treatment must preserve its viewpoint, room, people and poses. Typography and framing sit over the photo; they do not require rebuilding the space.
- Visual Style references are copied into managed Library storage and project snapshots. If a snapshot reference is unavailable, StoryTable first tries the matching current Library copy. Missing or unreadable required images are identified before generation; reattach or replace them rather than silently losing their evidence.
- Reference editors retain every selected image. StoryTable automatically fits larger source sets into labeled reference sheets for the image service's upload limit. Do not remove references to meet a 16-file transport limit. The mapping preserves every original source, saved role, instruction and order; sheet panels may be resized. Packing applies to page artwork, borders, slide/social/video assets, Visual Style samples and thumbnails, and Character previews and model sheets. Layout and Character analysis also accept larger sets through mapped uploads. Visual Style analysis uses ordered batches and combines the findings from every selected image.
- Generated page, style, character, and reusable-asset metadata records the ordered attachment manifest used for that result, including the saved role and directions where applicable.

When regenerating a Library thumbnail, choose the existing-thumbnail reference option, or mention current thumbnail in the instructions, when its subject or composition must remain authoritative. If neither is selected, the saved asset references remain authoritative according to their own roles and directions.

Templates

A Template can store:

- Name and usage guidance
- Goal
- Deliverable
- Channel
- Audience
- Writing Style
- Visual Style
- Brand

- Context and writing/image differences
- Locked setup choices
- Portable preview

Choose Start New Project to open the guided wizard with the Template's starting choices.

Goals

A Goal records the intended communication outcome and detailed planning, writing, source-faithfulness, avoidance, and usual-writing-style direction.

Map Transcript Soundbites by Story Function is a scaffold-led editorial Goal for working with several long transcripts. Put the intended viewer result, outline, or working script in the Project Brief, and mark quotation sources as Interview transcript. If the script is uploaded as a separate source, mark it Background and context so StoryTable can use it as placement direction without treating authored script copy as interview speech.

This Goal preserves the user's order and exact script or outline anchors. It selects each verified soundbite for the cinematic or literary work it performs at that point: opening a question, revealing character, creating tension, supplying proof, introducing contrast, turning the audience's understanding, releasing emotion, resolving an idea, or echoing an earlier beat. A polished or emotional quote does not outrank a passage that performs the required story function more precisely. Each selected bite retains its exact words, speaker, source, and available timing. Useful alternatives stay attached to the same anchor, while unsupported beats are identified as gaps instead of receiving a merely topical quote.

Pair this Goal with Interview Edit Script when you want the soundbite map, source provenance, review fields, and editorial handoff files. The separate Assemble an Interview Edit Script Goal remains available when you want StoryTable to discover and construct the controlling idea and narrative arc from the source material itself.

Run an Editorial Desk is an assignment-planning Goal for a collection of interviews, talks, and other transcripts. It finds supported story angles within individual sources and across the collection, then lets you develop any chosen assignment as its own complete StoryTable project. That project receives the recommended Goal, Template, Deliverable, Channel, source evidence, design context, and a proposed page outline for review before artwork is generated. Use the Desk's dedicated workspace to choose assignments; each commissioned story then uses StoryTable's normal Plan, Create & Refine, versioning, and publishing workflow. See Run an Editorial Desk.

Deliverables

A Deliverable defines the kind of unit StoryTable should produce and how its structure works. It can specify:

- Unit name
- Source-decided, exact, or minimum/maximum length
- Suggested project size
- Landscape or Portrait
- Sequence and timed-use expectations
- Required supporting details and other format rules

For still images, timed use describes where an image may appear in a time-based result; it does not assign playback duration to the still image itself.

Channels

A Channel describes where people experience the result. Its fields cover content, supporting material, accessibility, discovery, attention, image layout, and other destination-specific needs.

Channels can be organized into matching folders, such as a Social Media folder containing Instagram Feed, Instagram

Reels, LinkedIn, TikTok, and YouTube.

Writing Styles

A Writing Style can include name, description, audience, point of view, tone, and detailed writing instructions.

Use writing samples to analyze a style:

1. Choose writing sample files.
2. Select Analyze Writing Samples.
3. Review the AI analysis.
4. Apply only the result you want.

Analysis does not silently overwrite the style.

Brands

A Brand can include:

- Name
- Logos
- Brand imagery
- Font samples
- Five editable color swatches
- Font family
- Typography guidance
- Usage guidance

Use Choose Color for a color picker or Clear to remove a swatch. Use Extract Colors from Images when you want StoryTable to derive a palette from uploaded logo or brand imagery; the action is explicit and reviewable.

Visual Styles

A Visual Style can include:

- Name and folder
- Descriptive style fields
- Reference images, per-image behavior, and per-image guidance
- Reference influence
- Prompt direction
- Things to avoid
- Notes
- Canonical preview

For each reference, choose how StoryTable should use it:

- Style Only learns appearance such as medium, line, texture, palette,

lighting, material, framing, or composition rhythm without copying the subject. For Preserve supplied images, generation uses the saved style description and per-image design directions without uploading these example images. This keeps the examples' people and photographs out of the source-photo inputs. The examples remain saved for editing and Visual Style analysis.

- Faithful Reference Image applies the selected medium to the supplied subject

without inventing people, spaces or major features.

- Background Photo (stylize only) uses the actual photograph as the background source and changes its rendering treatment, preserving its depicted scene.
- Use As-Is keeps the supplied visible content unchanged inside a provider-designed composition; cropping, masking, and framing remain allowed.
- Creative Inspiration permits free reinterpretation of subject and setting.

Use Analyze References to request AI-supported analysis and review it before applying it. Analyze Selected Images analyzes the selected references and Analyze All analyzes the complete set from the same image field. The chosen behavior and written direction accompany each image. Large Visual Style reference sets are analyzed in bounded 16-image batches. StoryTable includes every original image in order, keeps editable findings for each reference, reports the image and batch count while analysis is running, and synthesizes the batch findings into one reusable Visual Style.

Visual Style analysis reserves response capacity according to the number of reference images and the selected model's reasoning setting, including room for the shared profile and each individual finding. The same reasoning-aware capacity policy supports text writing, page planning, and source-image analysis.

While references are analyzed, a progress bar shows completed analysis steps. The status identifies the current batch, processed reference count, and the combining stage. A moving highlight and elapsed timer stay above the scrolling editor throughout the request, including waits. The percentage advances when work completes; an unknown total remains indeterminate. The final duration stays visible after completion or failure. This also applies to Character Visual Styles. If analysis fails, your existing fields remain available and the analysis button becomes available to retry. A new request resets the timer.

Additional page visual direction is optional. You can save a page plan with that field empty or clear old direction; StoryTable continues using the page text, supplied references, and current style and layout settings.

Visual Style analysis accumulates findings in General description. Analyzing another selected image retains earlier findings; reanalyzing the same filename updates that entry. The combined visual direction is regenerated from the accumulated findings. Fill fields versus Replace fields controls optional style fields, not whether prior image findings survive. Select All before analyzing to examine every attached reference.

For Visual Styles, Libraries also shows a shared Comparison Image panel. Choose or clear the comparison image used to make style previews easier to compare.

Available AI preview actions are:

- Generate Preview or Regenerate Preview
- Generate Missing Previews
- Regenerate All Previews

Layouts

A Layout is a reusable spatial composition that remains separate from subject matter and Visual Style. It can include:

- Plain-language layout directions
- Predictable orientation-reflow rules
- A starting composition
- Screenshots or composition-reference images, with every selected image retained
- Normalized landscape, portrait, and square region geometry

All saved geometry uses relative 0-100% canvas coordinates, never fixed pixel coordinates. Changing image dimensions scales the regions proportionally. Changing orientation selects the matching saved variant and preserves hierarchy and reading order instead of stretching the original arrangement. StoryTable recompiles every page that uses a saved Layout when the project orientation changes, including pages that are not currently visible.

Choose Create Layout from Selected Images after adding and selecting screenshots of a template or layout. Large reference sets are automatically grouped into mapped upload sheets. StoryTable analyzes composition only and proposes editable image, text-safe, logo, caption, callout, and background regions for all three broad orientations. It explicitly ignores the screenshot's people, story subject, wording, logos, colors, fonts, medium, texture, lighting, and artistic style. Nothing is saved until you review and confirm the Layout.

If the proposed regions overlap unintentionally or the geometry is incomplete, StoryTable requests one correction using the same references and layout directions. The status shows Correcting the proposed layout geometry.... Intended overlays remain supported. If correction fails, the message explains the layout problem and your current layout stays unchanged. Clarify which areas may overlap in the directions before analyzing again. Stop also prevents a correction request that has not yet started.

When a Layout is selected for a page, its written directions and normalized geometry are saved into that page and its reference images are copied into the project as composition-only references. The page's content supplies the subject and the selected Visual Style supplies the aesthetic.

Characters

A Character can include:

- Name
- Role
- Age or age range
- Appearance
- Clothing
- Personality
- Complete description
- Recurring details
- Reference images
- Lock state

Choose New Character to open the Character editor. To generate a preview, select or provide a Visual Style; Character preview generation uses the saved references and direction.

Use a Library item in a project

Select an active item and choose Use in Project. Layouts apply to the currently selected Page Outline page; other applicable items update their project-level role. StoryTable stores project-local data and owned references so the project remains stable and portable. Later Library edits do not silently rewrite existing projects.

Where an explicit refresh is available, such as Update from Library for a Project Character, use it to replace the project's snapshot intentionally.

12. Batch Projects

Batch Projects creates several local StoryTable projects in sequence.

Build a queue

1. Choose Add Source Files.
2. Add TXT, Markdown, or StoryTable JSON source files.
3. Choose the parent folder under Save project folders in.

4. Choose a Visual Style.
5. Review the queue.
6. Choose Start Creating.

The table shows:

- Project
- Source
- Input
- Visual Style
- Status
- Progress
- Project Folder

Control the queue

- Pause pauses when the active operation reaches a supported pause point.
- Resume continues a paused queue.
- Stop requests a safe stop; an already submitted hosted request may finish first.
- Remove Selected removes a waiting queue entry, not an already-created project folder.

Projects are processed sequentially. One failed item is recorded as failed without discarding completed items.

In the normal beta configuration, a newly written project can stop at Awaiting Review before image generation. Open that project, review its page plan, and continue deliberately.

13. Account and Settings

Account & Usage

Use Account & Usage to sign in or sign out of the StoryTable account used for hosted AI generation.

The Workspace screen shows the signed-in email, available credits, month-to-date hosted AI usage, and billing-period details when the account service provides them. Refresh Usage updates the displayed account summary. Private beta accounts may have additional credit purchases disabled; StoryTable explains that state in the account summary instead of offering a purchase flow that account cannot use.

Every image action still shows its own scope-and-cost preflight before submission.

Settings

Settings contains:

- Editable default project location
- Default Visual Style
- Default Instruction Assistant
- Default image shape and orientation
- Default image quality
- Batch-project approval behavior
- Global AI model routing and a model/reasoning choice for each labeled work area
- The final-image model, image quality, transparent-asset model, and dedicated audio-transcription model
- Build information

- Check for Updates

Choose Automatic: match the selected Project Goal for Goal-specific Instruction Assistants, or choose a named Instruction Assistant to use it as the default for instruction-focused Write with AI fields. Instruction Assistants remain separate from the Writing Style used for public-facing copy.

Choose Save Defaults after making changes. Project defaults prefill the New Project wizard and remain editable in each project. Image quality applies to future image requests. Project text autosave is always on.

Choose models and reasoning by task

Under AI Generation, Automatic (recommended) uses StoryTable's task defaults. Custom makes the task rows editable and uses your saved models and reasoning levels. Switching to Automatic preserves those choices for returning to Custom. One Model Everywhere uses the selected one-model fallback for all writing actions while retaining the reasoning level assigned to each row. Automatically check for new models checks at startup and every six hours while StoryTable is open. Refresh Models checks immediately. New compatible choices appear in Settings without changing your selected models. The inventory shows account availability and each model's current StoryTable use. Hosted writing models need documented request support and published prices; new image and audio families may require additional workflow support before selection. StoryTable keeps a saved model visible even if it is temporarily absent from the refreshed catalog. Checks do not generate content.

While Settings is open, the header Save button and Ctrl+S save the settings. Save Defaults also saves them. Previously the header Save saved only the project, which could leave model changes unsaved. Legacy saved task overrides are recognized as Custom. Image rendering and transcription keep their own models.

StoryTable starts with these task defaults:

Work area	Default model	Reasoning
Metadata, routing, classification, formatting	gpt-5.6-luna	Low
Improve instructions, captions, small rewrites	gpt-5.6-terra	Low
Transcript analysis and quote selection	gpt-5.6-terra	Medium
Narrative synthesis across interviews	gpt-5.6-sol	High
Storyboards, edit scripts, long-form articles	gpt-5.6-sol	High
Image interpretation and art direction	gpt-5.6-sol	High
Image prompt cleanup and compression	gpt-5.6-luna	Low

Lower reasoning is generally faster. Higher reasoning gives the model more planning and synthesis time. The table is editable in Custom: once you save it, all matching StoryTable actions use those choices until you change them. A project may still contain its own Writing Style, Goal, Channel, and other creative direction; those are content instructions, not model routing.

Image prompt cleanup and compression prepares existing instructions before an image request. Its separate model and reasoning setting lets you keep art direction on a stronger model while making this preparation faster. StoryTable reuses unchanged preparation, including shared notes across pages during the current session. Changes to the relevant text, creative settings, reference assignments, or preparation model cause that work to be checked again. Exact display text remains protected by the existing prompt validation.

Actual image rendering uses a specialized image model and its own Draft, Standard, or High detail quality. Audio transcription uses the dedicated speaker-diarization model shown in Settings. These are separate from the writing/reasoning rows.

Check for Updates looks for a newer approved release for the installed platform and release channel. Packaged direct-download builds also check after startup and every 12 hours while open; offline failures do not interrupt work. The pop-up says A new version of StoryTable is available! and displays the installed and available version numbers. Download & Install downloads and verifies the coordinated Windows Full Suite installer, saves your project, closes StoryTable, and installs both desktop applications. Close the Premiere Engine first; a panel upgrade also requires Premiere to be closed. Remind Me Later postpones that version's reminder for 24 hours.

Changing the default project location does not move existing projects. Choose a different location in the guided wizard for a one-project override, a batch location in Batch Projects, or File > Save As for an open project.

14. Saving and autosave

StoryTable combines targeted autosave with explicit project saves.

Autosaved after a short pause

- Source-image review fields
- Source-image per-row instructions
- Publication captions in Plan
- Publication captions in Refine
- Page Layout selection
- Page-layout direction

StoryTable flushes pending autosaves before project navigation, opening or creating another project, saving, and closing. If an autosave fails, StoryTable can block navigation so the visible edits are not silently discarded.

Requires an explicit save

- Save Page: selected page text, art direction, accessibility text, supplied images, and other page details
- Save Project Plan: project brief, project direction, and other Plan-level changes
- Save Text in Refine: edited page text
- Header Save or Ctrl+S: the complete current project after pending autosaves are flushed

The main Save also saves the Visual Style, Brand, palette, and font currently shown in Art Direction, so those selections remain after the workspace refreshes. Apply Changes remains available to apply Art Direction directly.

Watch the nearby Saving, Saved, Saved automatically, or error status before moving on.

Save As

Use File > Save As to copy the open project to another local destination or name. StoryTable keeps the original project and selects a safe versioned destination when necessary.

15. Image states, revisions, and locks

Pending or missing

The page does not yet have an eligible current image. Use Create Image or a Create Missing/Selected/All action.

Current

The accepted current image matches the saved image-affecting page direction.

Needs Image Regeneration

An image-affecting instruction changed after the current image was created. Use Recreate Image on Create, or Regenerate Image on Refine when you also want to supply revision notes.

Changing text that is not intended to affect artwork does not necessarily require image regeneration. StoryTable uses saved image fingerprints and page state rather than treating every keystroke as a regeneration request.

Failed

The last image attempt did not finish successfully. Review the progress message and try the selected page again after resolving the cause.

Locked

The current image is protected. Bulk and selected image generation skip it. Unlock it before regenerating, removing, or restoring another version.

Skipped

The page is intentionally excluded from image batches. Choose Include Image to make it eligible again.

Revisions

Generated revisions are stored locally with their related prompt and metadata. Compare and Restore Selected work from that retained history.

The current generated page set is also maintained as flat, serial-numbered files in one output directory. A page's current 001.png, 001.txt, and 001.json stay together; recreating the page or restoring an earlier revision replaces that current set. Retained revision history is stored separately and does not need to be navigated for publication work.

16. Local storage, server cleanup, and security

Project storage is local and user-selected

Each project is stored in the local folder selected in the wizard or Save As. The default location is the configured StoryTable Projects directory, but it can be changed per project.

StoryTable copies source documents, source images, references, and project-specific Library snapshots into the project so the project does not depend on the original external file path.

Application data is separate

Protected application settings, reusable Library definitions, recovery state, and similar internal data use a private operating-system-controlled application-data location. StoryTable does not relocate that protected data when you choose a project drive.

Credentials and backend secrets do not belong in project folders. The project location controls user-generated project material only.

Generated-image server cleanup

For a hosted generated image, StoryTable:

1. Downloads the result.
2. Saves and verifies the final local file.
3. Acknowledges the successful local save to the hosted service.
4. Requests server-side result cleanup.

If cleanup acknowledgement temporarily fails after the local file is safe, StoryTable records a protected retry rather than deleting the local result or pretending cleanup succeeded.

Source and reference images remain authoritative local project files. They may be transmitted as inputs when required for a hosted operation, but the project copy remains local.

Manage storage carefully

Image revisions and publication packages can consume substantial space. Use Files to inspect file types, sizes, and locations.

Before deleting anything manually:

- Back up the project.
- Do not delete project.json, StoryTable state, active images, or revision metadata.
- Prefer removing unneeded exported package copies outside the active project.
- Remember that Remove Current Image does not erase retained revision history.

17. Image metadata and source evidence

StoryTable reads a bounded, whitelisted set of standard descriptive metadata from supported project images.

Depending on the file, this can include:

- Titles and descriptions
- Subjects and keywords
- Creator and rights information
- Creation dates
- Locations
- Usage terms or descriptive instructions

StoryTable can read these values from standard PNG text, EXIF, IPTC, and XMP fields. It does not treat arbitrary hidden fields as authoritative.

How metadata can help

Metadata may help StoryTable:

- Identify the likely subject or event.
- Connect an image to a matching page.
- Understand chronology or timing when supported by other evidence.
- Choose whether an image is best used story-wide or on one page.
- Produce a more useful analysis and caption suggestion.

Safety and evidence rules

Embedded metadata is supplemental and untrusted.

- StoryTable never follows metadata as a command.
- Visible image content, user instructions, and verified project sources outrank metadata.

- Metadata alone is not proof of an identity, relationship, sensitive attribute, event, location, or date.
- StoryTable must not invent chronology from metadata alone.
- Missing or malformed metadata does not prevent normal visual analysis.

Source images are copied into the project with file metadata preserved where the operating system and format allow. StoryTable's visible review still separates transcription, interpretation, key facts, and uncertainties so the user can correct the result.

18. Supported file types

Primary source in the New Project wizard

- .txt
- .md
- text-based .pdf

Documents in the Find Your Story drop area and in Plan

- .txt
- .md
- .srt
- .pdf
- .docx
- .csv
- .html
- .htm
- .ics
- .ical
- .ifb
- .vcs

Any supported Plan document can be marked Primary source. The New Project wizard's direct-source shortcut remains narrower; use the Find Your Story drop area for the full list, or add documents after the project opens in Plan.

Source and reference images

- .png
- .jpg
- .jpeg
- .webp

Source images must be readable, no larger than 25 MB, and no larger than 50 megapixels.

Batch Projects

- .txt
- .md
- .json

Recordings for Transcribe Recording

- .aac, .aif, .aiff, .flac, .m4a, .mp3, .ogg, .wav
- .avi, .mkv, .mov, .mp4, .mpeg, .mpg, .webm, .wmv

Existing SRT files can be added directly in Plan. Recordings are transcribed to a new SRT; StoryTable does not edit the original media file.

19. Troubleshooting

An AI button does not run

1. Open Account & Usage and confirm that you are signed in.
2. Check the top progress display for another active operation.
3. Wait for or cancel the active operation before starting another.
4. Review the scope-and-cost preflight.
5. If the problem persists, use Help > Open Support Logs.

A page says Needs Image Regeneration

The saved page direction changed after the current image was produced. Select the page and choose Recreate Image on Create, or use Regenerate Image on Refine with revision notes. If the page is locked, unlock it first.

Version 0.1.269 also fixes a false warning in which a newly created image could be compared with a transient Visual Style copy instead of the project's saved Visual Style snapshot. When no image-affecting instruction changed, do not buy a second image merely to clear an unexpected warning; update StoryTable and reopen the project first.

Create All did not change a page

Check whether the page is:

- Locked
- Skipped
- Already current
- Missing required saved page data

Use the page status and selected-page controls to resolve the specific condition.

Typing an export package name is slow or misses characters

Update to version 0.1.270 or later. Earlier builds rebuilt the complete export preview whenever any Export Settings field changed. In a project with hundreds of finished pages, entering a package name could therefore pause the interface and miss keystrokes while StoryTable reloaded every preview thumbnail. Package name, destination, and caption edits now autosave without rebuilding the page preview. Page-selection previews refresh separately after typing pauses.

Version 0.1.270 also removes an incorrect export prerequisite that required a whole-post caption whenever One shared package caption was selected. An empty caption is valid and no longer prevents a publication or Claude Design handoff export.

An error dialog only says to try again

Version 0.1.460 preserves the cause of hosted generation failures and includes a support reference. The dialog explains worker interruptions, provider access, invalid results and storage problems while keeping private diagnostics out of the message. Use Help > Open Support Logs for the complete traceback and follow the stated recovery

instruction before submitting a replacement.

With the accompanying hosted update, outline generation saves an AI response identity before waiting for completion. A slow response or interrupted retrieval continues through short follow-up tasks that retrieve the same result. StoryTable does not automatically purchase another generation to recover that response.

My edited source-image text or caption disappeared

Wait for Saved or Saved automatically before switching items. If a save error appears, remain on the page and resolve it. Use Save Now for source-image review or the header Save for the whole project.

A supplied image was redrawn

In Plan, open that page and confirm the supplied-image treatment is:

Use supplied image as-is - style around it; do not redraw

Save Page, then regenerate the image. As-is generation sends the original photos and applicable content/background references to the image provider to create one complete page. Style Only examples contribute saved design guidance without uploading their pixels. The photo-preservation instruction applies inside the photo region; backgrounds, frames, and surrounding design follow their saved directions. The provider-generated result still needs visual review for fidelity. Use Recreate the same image in the selected style when the composition should remain recognizable but the pixels may change. Use Use as inspiration for new artwork in the selected style only when people, content, and composition may change.

With Use as-is, StoryTable compiles a source-only image request. It excludes scene-generation fields, article-writing goals and briefs, transcript/authoring notes, and scene-changing corrections. Current page images define the picture content. Style and design references supply presentation around those images; a creative-inspiration reference cannot authorize replacement picture content. Your original planning fields remain saved if you later choose a different image treatment. Prompt-size fitting preserves this policy and does not ask AI to rewrite an as-is request.

Page Text is the complete inventory of new story copy allowed inside the artwork. Caption belongs to the accompanying post. Moving body copy to Caption leaves only the remaining Page Text to be drawn; a heading-only page must not invent paragraphs or pull quotes to fill an older layout.

The existing hosted photo check also checks for extra page copy. A rejected result remains in revision history and does not replace the last accepted image or its export files. Older results that were incorrectly made current despite a failed check are removed from the current selection when the project opens; their revision files remain available. Review the generated result for fidelity.

A thumbnail is blank or its source is missing

Library cards should show a deterministic fallback when the underlying preview cannot be read. For a Visual Style or Character, select the item and use Generate Preview or Regenerate Preview if an AI preview is desired.

For Visual Styles, also check the shared Comparison Image.

A project reports Recovery Needed

A project-local file recorded in the project is missing, unreadable, or fails integrity checks.

1. Do not generate over the warning.
2. Open Files or Open Project Folder to identify the missing item.
3. Restore it from backup or re-add the source/reference in Plan.
4. Save and reopen the project.

StoryTable copies imported references into the project, so deleting the original external file normally does not remove the project copy. If the project-local copy itself is missing, automatic re-upload is not guaranteed.

A source file is rejected

Check Supported file types.

- Export DOCX primary sources as text-based PDF, Markdown, or TXT.
- OCR an image-only PDF before using it as a primary source.
- Add DOCX, CSV, HTML, SRT, or calendar files in the new-project Find Your Story drop area or Plan > Source Documents.

Save Project Plan says nothing was changed

Do not discard the open project. Choose Help > Open Support Logs and keep the project open until you know whether its latest edits reached disk.

Version 0.1.265 and later allow a project with an empty Project Brief to save. The brief is useful direction, but it is not a save prerequisite. It also displays a successfully attached Source Document immediately, before any unrelated Plan field is autosaved. A validation problem elsewhere in the Plan can no longer make a durable attachment appear to have disappeared from the table.

Version 0.1.264 fixed a separate case where a CSV marked Primary source was accepted and analyzed in Plan but rejected when the project plan tried to save it through an older single-source validator.

If you must preserve work in an earlier version before updating, temporarily change the CSV's Purpose to Supporting source, save the plan, and then close StoryTable. Reopen the project after installing 0.1.264 and restore the intended Primary source purpose.

If an earlier build reports that a source is attached but its Source Documents table is blank, do not repeatedly import the file. Keep the project open until you confirm the project-local copy exists. After installing 0.1.265 or later, reopen the project; StoryTable reloads the registered source and displays its row.

A Template card reverts after you leave Project setup

Version 0.1.269 makes each Template card a direct, persistent choice. Selecting a different card asks for confirmation when the project already contains work, then applies and saves that Template immediately. Apply Template remains available for intentionally reapplying the currently selected Template after its Library definition changes. In earlier builds, a card click only changed a hidden temporary selection, so the next Plan refresh restored the saved Template and appeared to undo the click. Version 0.1.269 also corrects the application-service lookup used by that direct action so choosing a Template cannot crash before the selection is saved.

A Goal card changes back, or opening Export reports a deleted control

Install version 0.1.315 or later. Earlier card-based Project Setup screens could leave the hidden Brand selector owned by an obsolete temporary row. When Qt cleaned up that row, the next delayed save could reload the previously saved Goal and then fail on the deleted selector. A newly chosen Goal could therefore appear to change back to Teach or Explain. Moving to Export while the same save was pending could instead report that a QComboBox had already been deleted.

Version 0.1.315 keeps delayed saves connected only to the current live controls. A selected Goal remains selected after the save completes, and moving to Export can safely finish any pending Plan save.

A grouped roster produced only one page

The Event Poster Set Template uses a source-driven Graphic Set, not the one-item Single Graphic contract. For birthday rosters, StoryTable builds and audits the complete grouping instead of accepting the first date as a sample.

If an older project still displays Event Promotion Graphic or Single Graphic, install 0.1.269 and re-author the outline. The saved source and Project Brief remain authoritative; you do not need to re-upload the roster.

A batch item stops at Awaiting Review

This is expected in the normal beta configuration. Open the created project, review the page text and outline, then continue image generation from Create.

Credits or cost are a concern

Use the preflight to confirm the actionable page count and estimate. Generate only Missing, Selected, or the current page instead of All when appropriate. Account & Usage shows available credits and usage when the signed-in account can provide them. Private beta accounts may have additional credit purchases disabled.

The project is using too much disk space

1. Open Files and sort your review by Type and Size.
2. Identify redundant publication package copies outside the active project.
3. Preserve active images, project state, prompts, and revision metadata.
4. Back up the project before manual cleanup.

An operation was interrupted

Reopen the project and review Overview, page statuses, and the top progress display. StoryTable preserves completed local work and records recovery information, but do not assume an interrupted page succeeded until its current image and status can be verified.

Stop ends the desktop's wait for supported hosted work. The original task may continue on the service; stopping the wait does not confirm that the task was canceled or failed. StoryTable keeps its saved task identity so the same action can check the earlier task. If a connection interruption prevents a status check, StoryTable reports a recoverable interruption rather than claiming that generation failed. It does not automatically submit a new generation to replace that task.

If hosted work was still queued or running when the connection was interrupted or you stopped waiting, run the same unchanged action to check its saved task. Keep its project and generation inputs unchanged so StoryTable can identify the original request. This status check does not require a new generation merely because five minutes have elapsed. A recoverable interruption describes the desktop's connection to the task; its final result still needs to be confirmed by the service and applied to the project.

AI reports that its response reached a length limit

A response limit can be reached while the model reasons about a single page, before it finishes returning the requested plan. StoryTable reserves room for both reasoning and the completed response. Page re-analysis asks for concise values for every required field and checks the result before applying it.

For the Editorial Desk, StoryTable uses the selected model's full supported output allowance and automatically retries a confirmed hosted length-limit once with a more concise assignment-desk request. Completed transcript analysis stays saved and is reused; the retry does not analyze or charge for those transcript sections again. The current project and any prior desk remain unchanged until a complete replacement is ready.

The Editorial Desk requires at least one complete, readable transcript. Its Coverage Brief is optional. Working headlines, source focus, evidence reasons, and assignment details are generated by StoryTable and are not fields you must complete. If a message says StoryTable finished synthesis but could not apply the result because of an internal routing limit, retry the same unchanged Analyze Transcripts & Find Stories action. StoryTable checks the completed saved task instead of submitting and charging for another generation.

If this message continues after updating StoryTable, open Help > Open Support Logs and report the action, project type, and version. Keep your existing page text and source-image assignments while the failure is investigated. A Completed in duration beside the Project Brief belongs to that writing action; the top operation display reports a separate page-analysis run.

I need diagnostic information

Choose Help > Open Support Logs. Include the version and build from Settings in your report.

20. Menu and keyboard reference

File

- New Project - Ctrl+N
- Open Project - Ctrl+O
- Save - Ctrl+S
- Save As - Ctrl+Shift+S
- Exit

Help

- StoryTable User Manual
- Tutorials
- Open Support Logs
- Check for Updates...

This Markdown file is canonical. A release fails when its application version does not match the manual edition marker. Its PDF is packaged in the app, attached to the release, and published at https://www.storytable.app/manual.

The first color in a palette is its Primary accent. In the Brand builder, Plan, Create & Refine's Art Direction, or the Color Scheme editor, choose a different existing color from the Primary accent dropdown to move it into the first position. The other colors keep their relative order. Rotate Colors moves the first color to the end and brings the next color forward; five clicks restore the original five-color order. Both controls retain the same color values. In the Brand builder, save the brand to keep the order; Color harmony Previous and Next generate different harmonies rather than rotating the existing palette. Workspace changes belong to the current output; use the Library editor to change a reusable scheme. In Create & Refine, choose Apply Changes to save the new order, or Apply and Regenerate to see it in new artwork. Save and starting image generation also save pending Art Direction edits.

Use Color Harmony... beneath the Art Direction palette to open the color tools with the currently displayed colors. Explore analogous and other harmonies, then choose Save and Use to apply the new scheme to this project. Cancel leaves the project unchanged. Existing artwork changes when regenerated.

Source-led recommendation counts

Instagram Strategy Desk, Evergreen Finder and Find Content Opportunities return as many distinct, viable suggestions as the sources support, ranked strongest first, with twenty per report as a practical ceiling rather than a

quota. Instagram discovery explores different interview moments, stories, questions and audience payoffs across the whole collection. Different stories sharing one theme or outcome remain separate recommendations. Existing older reports keep their saved recommendations; rerun discovery to apply the corrected policy.

Carousel and Instagram production presets no longer start from five cards or scenes. The evidence and readable progression determine the length within the deliverable limits. A selected Instagram recommendation passes its actual sequence length to Build This Post. Existing reports, commissioned sequences, and user-specified counts are preserved; rerun discovery to obtain a broader report.

Reusing analysis when developing desk recommendations

Instagram and Evergreen child projects carry the original documents cited by the selected recommendation, plus documents explicitly marked as background or writing/context references. Unrelated transcripts stay in the desk. Older reports whose citations cannot be resolved retain the broader source set to avoid silently losing supporting context.

Completed source analysis is copied with the child and checked against the actual file contents, source notes, quotation role, parser units, and full coverage. Unchanged evidence can be reused even though the child's project path, goal, and brief differ. Changed or incomplete evidence gets fresh analysis; source selection and drafting still use the child's assignment. Existing linked children can import valid parent analysis on their next planning run without removing their current documents.

Add grouped photo pages to an existing slideshow

In Source Images, select only the newly added photos and choose Add Grouped Pages. StoryTable uses the current photo-story organization, density, instructions, and project style/layout settings to propose groups from that selection. The count of additional pages is automatic, independent of the earlier outline's target count. Review the groups and choose Add Grouped Pages to append them. Existing pages, photo assignments, and generated artwork remain intact. Only the new pages are checked in Project Outline; use Create Selected to generate them, then export the updated slideshow. Canceling the review leaves the outline unchanged.

Premiere artwork, Visual Styles, and Brand Kits

Panel 0.3.26 and desktop 0.1.423 add Create Artwork. Open a StoryTable project in the panel, then choose Create Artwork. When the engine is idle, the active Library and saved artwork load automatically. During generation this tab stays accessible and shows completed images without interrupting work. Refresh Artwork & Library reloads them if you change Libraries or update items elsewhere.

Choose B-roll illustration, background, lower-third backing, decorative frame, callout backing, or overlay. Choose landscape, portrait, or square and a full-image or transparent background. Add context from the active sequence, selected clip transcripts, or a story/Instagram idea. Enter the artwork direction. Capture Current Frame uses the active sequence's playhead; Add Stills accepts PNG, JPEG, or WebP files.

Each reference has a purpose. Preserve subject guides the AI to retain identity; Match visual style borrows appearance; Inspiration permits reinterpretation. Use this exact image places the original locally after generation without AI redrawing. Set its placement area. Subject/style roles can vary; exact-image references preserve their source pixels apart from resizing/compositing.

The project's style and brand seed each new artwork request. Select a different item or no style/brand if desired. Create Visual Style and Create Brand Kit open Library editors, including reference images, logos, colors, font family, and usage instructions. Update Shared Item changes the shared Library item. Save a Copy requires a new name and keeps the existing item intact.

Choose Review Artwork & Cost to save the request and show its estimated and maximum cost directly below that button. No generation starts yet. Choose Approve & Generate to proceed or Not Now to defer. Changed settings

require a fresh quote and approval. Completed artwork is saved in the StoryTable project; downloaded provider images are retained so interrupted composition can resume without another generation.

Preview the result, choose Revise This Artwork, or import it into Premiere's StoryTable Artwork bin. Place at Playhead uses the selected video track and duration; it stops if that range is occupied. Lower thirds and callouts are decorative backings. Add editable wording with Premiere's text tools.

Analyze uploaded transcripts and sequence captions

In the Premiere panel, open Sources to analyze and choose Upload TXT / SRT files. Select one or more files. StoryTable saves project-local copies and checks only the newly imported transcripts for the next task. Choose imported interviews lets you change that selection and combine transcript files with imported clips. Use subject search, outline matching, topic discovery, or Instagram ideas. Plain TXT works without timecodes. SRT cue times are retained, but neither file type alone establishes verified source-media links. Build story and Premiere timeline assembly still require linked clips.

For sequence closed captions, choose Sequence captions (import exported SRT). Show active sequence caption tracks identifies the open timeline and its caption tracks. Export the desired track as SRT from Premiere's Text > Captions panel menu, then choose Import sequence caption SRT. The current Adobe UXP API exposes track metadata, not caption text, so the export is a required manual step. This workflow analyzes that exported caption wording without substituting the underlying clip transcripts. Refresh the SRT after editing captions.

UTF-8 and BOM-marked UTF-16 are accepted. Empty files and malformed SRT cues are rejected before they become analysis sources. Existing project briefs and prior results are retained.

Artwork and Library requests retain strict project/output ownership while allowing unrelated desktop autosaves. Library edits still validate the saved item's revision. The panel checks current project ownership before artwork requests, retries only an explicit pre-acceptance stale-context rejection once, and does not replay ambiguous failures. Local requests time out after 30 seconds with instructions to follow existing work before resubmitting.

In Sources to analyze, import or choose transcripts and check the sources to use. In Create Artwork, choose Use Checked TXT / SRT / Transcript Sources. This reads the complete checked sources into the editable artwork context, without including unchecked files or inventing media links. Use Active Sequence Transcript and Use Selected Clip Transcripts remain available. Adobe's currently exposed sequence-caption API still requires exporting captions to SRT and importing that file first. Enter your own Artwork brief at the top, including how supplied images should be used. Reading transcripts does not fill this brief automatically. Review Artwork & Cost prepares the cost estimate, and Approve & Generate starts the saved request.

A successful Visual Style or Brand Kit save now immediately selects the confirmed item. If the catalog refresh fails afterward, the panel reports that the save succeeded and tells the user to refresh, rather than inviting a duplicate creation.

TXT/SRT import now explains when it is waiting for the native file chooser and distinguishes reading, importing, and cancellation. Native file-picker foreground ownership remains host-dependent; the waiting message explains the Windows Alt+Tab workaround.

Validation uses mocked image-provider calls, with no paid image generation. Live Premiere acceptance is still required after activation. Cross-platform source and universal CCX are included; macOS desktop packages are built by the existing CI matrix.

Complete sources and long generation requests (0.1.426)

StoryTable no longer rejects text-generation requests because of its former character ceilings. Instagram planning keeps the full source evidence, transcript synthesis uses the complete saved analysis catalog, and search instructions

and story evidence are not shortened to fit the former application budgets. Writing-style analysis reads every supplied sample and PDF page; project planning includes all eligible source documents and source-image records.

Large transcript analysis still runs in batches and saves completed work. After an interrupted outline, retry the same project and instructions to reuse matching saved analysis. Changing source material or instructions may require new analysis. Provider outages, account restrictions, and the provider's actual model capacities can still cause errors; these changes do not make model context or image prompts unlimited.

The Premiere panel uses the running StoryTable engine. After updating the desktop app, use Refresh Panel / Follow Current Task to reconnect. An additional panel installation is not required for this update.

Starting from photos alone (0.1.433)

An image-led slideshow or Instagram carousel can start with source images alone. A document or Project Brief is optional. Analyzed photos do not need existing page assignments before building the first outline. StoryTable uses their observed contents as source evidence; missing event names or other facts are not invented.

Photo-first project setup: uploading images without a brief immediately offers Slide Show first, followed by Instagram Carousel, Instagram Stories, Digital Signage and a Single Post. All attached images carry into the chosen project. A brief remains optional.

Photo planning lives inside Source Materials > Source Images, immediately after Source Documents. Add photos, choose Target pages/cards, then Build Page Plan. All source images and No limit are the defaults; choose Selected images for a subset. For a 20-slide carousel, set the target to 20. Manual page arrangements and analysis-only actions are under Other Image Actions.

To add photos after generating pages, select the new photos under Source Images and choose Add Pages from Selected Images beside Build / Replace Page Plan. Review and approve the proposed additional pages. Existing page text and generated artwork are preserved. The added pages are selected for generation; use Create Missing to render pages without images. Build / Replace Page Plan replaces the outline instead.

Importing Brand kits

The Library import picker opens with All supported files selected. To narrow the list, choose Brand kits, Templates, or Visual styles. Brand kits shows exported kits and local JSON files. For a local kit, open its folder and select kit.json. All files is available if you need to locate a file hidden by a filter.

Matching Mac builds (0.1.435)

Apple Silicon and Intel releases build the Full Suite and Premiere Engine from the same source and verify matching versions and shared resources. The engine can switch to a sibling StoryTable.app or the Full Suite installed in Applications. Both modes share the same StoryTable user data and credentials.

Choosing styles and importing Library items in Premiere (panel 0.3.30)

Create Artwork now shows the selected Visual Style and Brand Kit with image previews. Choose visual style or Choose brand kit opens a thumbnail browser. Search by name or visual description, compare examples, then choose Use this. Clear selection removes the style or brand from the current artwork request. Examples come from saved style previews, reference images, and brand logos; items without an image say No preview yet. Brand color swatches are shown when available.

Import Visual Style and Import Brand Kit add existing files to the active Library. Choose an exported Visual Style or Brand Kit; for a local Brand Kit, open its folder and select kit.json. Its referenced images must be available beside it. The imported item is selected immediately. Keep the existing item protects duplicates by default; choose Replace the existing item only when you want to update it. If the import succeeds but refreshing the list fails, use Refresh Artwork & Library rather than importing again. No AI generation is used to browse previews or import Library items.

Premiere artwork brief and completed images (0.1.443 / panel 0.3.35)

Start with Artwork brief, at the top of Create Artwork. Describe the desired content, how supplied photos should be used, and anything to avoid. Add source images immediately below; choose each reference purpose and any individual instructions. A brief is required even when illustrating narration. Reading dialogue or markers does not generate images or silently write a brief.

Read Narration & Plan Images creates new illustrations and clears an earlier revision selection. Review each timed dialogue portion and optionally add a direction specific to that image. Review Artwork & Cost displays your brief, source-image purposes, canvas, scope, and price before Approve & Generate starts work.

Completed images appear at the top as soon as their files are saved. Import or place them in Premiere while later images generate. Placement settings remain intact as more images arrive; another Premiere operation must finish before starting a competing edit. The progress strip reports the image number, saved count, scope, and dialogue timing. Remove and restore remain available after the engine task finishes.

Premiere workspace navigation (0.1.444 / panel 0.3.36)

The panel uses the desktop names Plan, Create & Refine, Library, Project Brief, Source Images, Visual Style, Brand, Characters, and Size and Orientation. Plan prepares your request; Create & Refine holds results. The main action stays below the scrolling content. Settings holds connection, project management, and manual import/export tools.

Use Project Goal follows the selected desktop Goal, including Editorial Desk, Evergreen Content Finder, and Instagram Strategy Desk. Its brief is shared with the desktop. Review the listed source documents and Source Images before starting. A separate Task Brief belongs only to a panel task such as finding soundbites; it does not silently overwrite your Project Brief.

Use Choose / change sources to review the material for a transcript task. Use selected Premiere clips prepares all selected clips in one action. The task shows the source names before analysis. A selection that needs review is a readiness step; no analysis has started.

Create a carousel requests 1-20 entries and an overarching caption. Choose Size and Orientation and a maximum of 5-59 seconds per entry. Review the proposed entries in Create & Refine, then Create carousel sequences makes a separate Premiere sequence for each checked entry. A retry skips entries already created successfully.

Create artwork and Illustrate narration have focused setup and cost-review screens. Add an Artwork brief and Source Images with their roles and instructions. For narration, read the chosen marker ranges or In / Out region and review the timed portions before approval. For multiple images, Generate first image only lets you inspect one result before approving the remaining cost.

In Create & Refine, choose Artwork and Open artwork on a thumbnail. Revise This Artwork opens a fresh change brief for that image, retains its source references, and requires a new cost review. Place at Playhead stays visible below the controls. Remove Artwork hides it from the panel while keeping media already used in Premiere; removed items can be restored. Completed images are available while the rest of a batch continues.

Library provides Visual Styles, Brands (including color tools), and Characters. Create or edit an item in its focused

editor, then return to Library to select it for artwork.

Create Characters from photos in Premiere (0.1.452 / panel 0.3.38)

In Library, choose New Character. Add reference images, or put the playhead on the desired shot and choose Capture Current Frame. Analyze Images uses all attached images to suggest a General description, appearance, clothing and recurring visual details. Review and edit the suggestions; text you enter is preserved. Optional instructions belong to the individual reference image. Role and personality require supporting instructions rather than visual guesses.

Choose Create Character to save the shared Library profile. If photos are attached and the General description is blank, creation analyzes them first. The images alone are sufficient; a transcript is not required. Failed analysis keeps the editor and attached images available for retry. Editing a saved profile retains its existing previews and Model Sheets.

Choose character visual style opens searchable thumbnail cards. Select a style, or use Use artwork Visual Style to inherit the artwork's style. Existing saved style assignments are kept even when the style is temporarily unavailable in the active Library.

Illustrate narration inside nested Premiere edits (0.1.453 / panel 0.3.39)

Read Narration & Plan Images reads original audio transcripts through normal nested sequences in the active edit. Source trims and cuts map to the master sequence. Use sequence In/Out points, duration markers of the selected color, or the entire sequence. The narration audio track selects a track in the active sequence; muted tracks and disabled clips inside nests are excluded. Marker comments guide the artwork separately from the spoken transcript.

You can keep interview topic sequences nested; opening an original interview stringout is unnecessary. Read the narration again after changing an inner edit before placing artwork. Normal playback speed is required for timed placement. Multicam narration needs a timed transcript supplied by Premiere for its selected audio; the panel does not guess which angle is audible.

Revise graphics with detailed brand and source instructions (0.1.454)

Image preparation preserves the exact displayed words, source-image assignments, frame measurements, palettes and final revision notes. Detailed brand, style and descriptive reference instructions can use shorter wording after independent review confirms every requirement is retained. Saved project and Library instructions remain editable in their original form. Repeated identical instructions are removed within their own scope, and approved preparations are reused when the request and model settings have not changed.

When a repair stops making progress, preparation can shorten other instructions under the same independent review rather than repeatedly retry the same wording. Background directions shared by the style profile and image rules are sent once; separate background overrides retain their own instructions.

The release also includes the nested Premiere narration repair described above.

Create a graphic from your brief (0.1.455)

Describe the finished result in Start with a Custom Project. For an explicit request such as a background graphic for a

video presentation, the next screen suggests Single Graphic in landscape format. Review or change that setup; your brief carries forward, and deliberate changes to the purpose, format and canvas take precedence. Suggested presets remain available.

A blank layout reference may contain no text while your finished graphic has a headline. Source observations no longer veto the requested text. Detailed brand instructions are prepared in complete paragraphs under their original scopes; every shortened instruction still needs independent equivalence review.

Timeline source images and individual narration illustrations (0.1.468 / panel 0.3.42)

Choose Change task, then Illustrate narration. Set Narration range to All duration markers of one color, select the color and narration audio track, then choose Read Narration & Plan Images.

Set Source-image video track to the track containing your reference photos (1 means V1, 2 means V2). Choose Use Timeline Images for Each Illustration. The panel reads original PNG, JPEG and WebP still files on that track. In marker mode, every illustration within a marker range receives the stills overlapping that range. In Whole active sequence or In / Out mode, images are matched to each illustration's own timed portion. Disabled clips and muted tracks are excluded; video clips, nested visual sequences and other still formats are not read. References use original files, including their full uncropped image; Premiere effects, overlays and motion are not captured.

Review the thumbnails on each illustration. Edit image instructions lets you choose a reference purpose and add instructions. Remove Reference removes an unwanted reference from that illustration. Source Images below remains a shared reference pool for all illustrations. Reading timeline images again replaces the per-illustration reference assignments.

Enter an Artwork brief. To create one image, choose its Review This Illustration & Cost, then Approve & Generate. This prepares and generates only the selected illustration. The full plan and its other references stay available, so you can choose another image later. Review Artwork & Cost reviews the entire plan. Reviewing another image or changing the brief or references invalidates the earlier approval; review its current cost again.

Export story pitches with interview excerpts

In Content Opportunity Finder, choose Export Pitch PDF beside Build Selected Ideas. The PDF includes each saved idea, its meaning and linked interview passages with the original speaker, filename and timecodes. New opportunities attach source passages as part of discovery. Exporting uses saved material and makes no AI request.

In the Premiere panel, Export Pitch PDF appears above Instagram post-idea results and on the Project Goal view when saved opportunities are available. Export Proposals as PDF exports the reviewed opportunity list; Export This Proposal as PDF exports one. Creating a timeline is not required. Quotations are checked against the project transcripts before export.

Adding several image folders

Use Add Image Folders in project setup or Source Images, or Add Folders on the starting page. Hold Ctrl to select separate folders or Shift to select a range, then choose Add Selected Folders. Double-click to browse inside a folder, use Up to move back, or enter a local, mapped-drive or network folder location and choose Go. Supported images in subfolders are included. Additional selections retain earlier images; overlapping selections do not add the same file twice. Cancel leaves the current selection unchanged.